

UPSC Civil Services Preliminary Examination - General Studies Paper I

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 2 Hours | Maximum Marks: 200

Quick Key

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Detailed solutions

Q1. Answer: A | Polity

Article 74 control Consider the following statements: 1. The President may require ministerial advice to be reconsidered once. 2. After reconsideration, the President may permanently reject the advice. 3. Article 74(2) bars inquiry into the advice but does not necessarily bar review of the resulting action. Which is correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct. The 44th Amendment allows one reconsideration, and Article 74(2) shields the advice from inquiry without making the resulting action immune from review.

B. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. It omits statement 3, which preserves review of the executive action on constitutional grounds even though ministerial advice itself is protected.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Statement 2 invents a permanent presidential veto after reconsideration, contrary to the binding character of reiterated advice.

D. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Statement 2 is false, while statement 1 correctly recognises the single reconsideration opportunity.

Method / explanation: Correct. The 44th Amendment allows one reconsideration, and Article 74(2) shields the advice from inquiry without making the resulting action immune from review.

Trap: Do not convert Article 74(2)'s advice privilege into immunity for the executive action or its supporting material.

Q2. Answer: B | Polity

With reference to Articles 36 and 37, consider the following statements: 1. "State" in Part IV has the same meaning as in Part III. 2. Every Directive Principle creates an enforceable claim once Parliament has not acted for a reasonable period. 3. Article 37 combines non-enforceability with a duty on the State in making laws. Which statements are correct?

A. 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "2 only" fails against the controlling rule. Statements 1 and 3 reproduce Articles 36-37. Delay does not automatically convert every directive into a judicially enforceable claim. Courts may use DPSP interpretively, but Article 37 remains.

B. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: Statements 1 and 3 reproduce Articles 36-37. Delay does not automatically convert every directive into a judicially enforceable claim. Courts may use DPSP interpretively, but Article 37 remains. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

C. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "1 and 2 only" fails against the controlling rule. Statements 1 and 3 reproduce Articles 36-37. Delay does not automatically convert every directive into a judicially enforceable claim. Courts may use DPSP interpretively, but Article 37 remains.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "1, 2 and 3" fails against the controlling rule. Statements 1 and 3 reproduce Articles 36-37. Delay does not automatically convert every directive into a judicially enforceable claim. Courts may use DPSP interpretively, but Article 37 remains.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 3 reproduce Articles 36-37. Delay does not automatically convert every directive into a judicially enforceable claim. Courts may use DPSP interpretively, but Article 37 remains. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Trap: Article 36 imports the Part III meaning of State; it does not create a narrower Union-only addressee.

Q3. Answer: C | Polity

Consider the following: 1. Article 49 protects nationally important monuments/places/objects declared by or under Parliamentary law. 2. Article 50 directs separation of judiciary from executive in State public services. 3. Article 51 encourages settlement of international disputes by arbitration. Which are correct?

A. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "1 only" fails against the controlling rule. All reproduce often-neglected textual elements of Articles 49-51.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "2 and 3 only" fails against the controlling rule. All reproduce often-neglected textual elements of Articles 49-51.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - CORRECT: Correct: All reproduce often-neglected textual elements of Articles 49-51. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

D. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "1 and 2 only" fails against the controlling rule. All reproduce often-neglected textual elements of Articles 49-51.

Method / explanation: All reproduce often-neglected textual elements of Articles 49-51. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Trap: Article 49 contains a Parliamentary-law declaration filter that a generic heritage option may omit.

Q4. Answer: D | Polity

Consider the following amendment changes: 1. 42nd - Articles 39A, 43A and 48A 2. 44th - Article 38(2) 3. 86th - Article 21A and recast Article 45 4. 97th - Article 43B Which is the correct assessment?

A. 1, 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "1, 2 and 3 only" fails against the controlling rule. The Forty-second Amendment recast Article 39(f) and inserted Articles 39A, 43A and 48A; the Forty-fourth inserted Article 38(2), the Eighty-sixth inserted Article 21A and recast Article 45, and the Ninety-seventh inserted Article 43B.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "2 and 3 only" fails against the controlling rule. The Forty-second Amendment recast Article 39(f) and inserted Articles 39A, 43A and 48A; the Forty-fourth inserted Article 38(2), the Eighty-sixth inserted Article 21A and recast Article 45, and the Ninety-seventh inserted Article 43B.

C. 1 and 4 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "1 and 4 only" fails against the controlling rule. The Forty-second Amendment recast Article 39(f) and inserted Articles 39A, 43A and 48A; the Forty-fourth inserted Article 38(2), the Eighty-sixth inserted Article 21A and recast Article 45, and the Ninety-seventh inserted Article 43B.

D. All four are correctly matched - CORRECT: Correct: The Forty-second Amendment recast Article 39(f) and inserted Articles 39A, 43A and 48A; the Forty-fourth inserted Article 38(2), the Eighty-sixth inserted Article 21A and recast Article 45, and the Ninety-seventh inserted Article 43B. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Method / explanation: The Forty-second Amendment recast Article 39(f) and inserted Articles 39A, 43A and 48A; the Forty-fourth inserted Article 38(2), the Eighty-sixth inserted Article 21A and recast Article 45, and the Ninety-seventh inserted Article 43B. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Trap: Amendment questions test both insertion and recasting: Article 45 survived the Eighty-sixth Amendment in a new form.

Q5. Answer: A | Polity

Which matching is correct? 1. Article 43 - living wage and cottage industries 2. Article 43A - workers' participation in management 3. Article 43B - voluntary, autonomous, democratic and professionally managed co-operatives

A. 1, 2 and 3 - CORRECT: Correct: The three adjacent Articles test wage/cottage economy, industrial participation and co-operative governance respectively. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

B. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "1 only" fails against the controlling rule. The three adjacent Articles test wage/cottage economy, industrial participation and co-operative governance respectively.

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "1 and 3 only" fails against the controlling rule. The three adjacent Articles test wage/cottage economy, industrial participation and co-operative governance respectively.

D. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "2 and 3 only" fails against the controlling rule. The three adjacent Articles test wage/cottage economy, industrial participation and co-operative governance respectively.

Method / explanation: The three adjacent Articles test wage/cottage economy, industrial participation and co-operative governance respectively. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Trap: Articles 43, 43A and 43B test three different ideas: worker welfare, industrial participation and co-operative governance.

Q6. Answer: B | Polity

With reference to Article 245, consider the following statements: 1. Parliament may make laws for the whole or any part of India. 2. A parliamentary law is not invalid merely because it has extra-territorial operation. 3. A State law can never affect a person or transaction outside the State. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Statement 3 ignores territorial nexus, under which a real and pertinent connection may support limited extra-State effect of State law.

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct. Clauses (1) and (2) give Parliament territorial reach and protect its law from invalidity merely for extra-territorial operation.

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Statement 3 is too absolute even though statement 1 correctly describes Parliament's basic territorial power.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The first two statements are textually sound, but the categorical denial of territorial nexus makes statement 3 false.

Method / explanation: Correct. Clauses (1) and (2) give Parliament territorial reach and protect its law from invalidity merely for extra-territorial operation.

Trap: Article 245 distinguishes Parliament's extra-territorial rule from the judicially developed territorial-nexus limit on State law.

Q7. Answer: C | Polity

Consider the following pairs: 1. Article 51A(e) - harmony, common brotherhood and dignity of women 2. Article 51A(g) - environment and compassion for living creatures 3. Article 51A(h) - scientific temper, humanism, inquiry and reform 4. Article 51A(b) - defence of the country and national service Which pairs are correctly matched?

A. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: This omits the correctly matched clause (h) while retaining only the first two pairs.

B. 2, 3 and 4 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Pair 4 is wrong because national defence belongs to clause (d), not clause (b).

C. 1, 2 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: Clauses (e), (g) and (h) contain precisely the first three listed combinations.

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Including pair 4 makes the set wrong despite the accuracy of pairs 1-3.

Method / explanation: Clauses (e), (g) and (h) contain precisely the first three listed combinations.

Trap: A single shifted clause invalidates an otherwise plausible matching set.

Q8. Answer: D | Polity

Which statement about the current Article 31C is correct?

A. It protects every law implementing any Directive Principle from every Fundamental Right. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "It protects every law implementing any Directive Principle from every Fundamental Right." fails against the controlling rule. This is the combined effect of Kesavananda Bharati (1973), Minerva Mills (1980) and Property Owners Association (2024).

B. It was wholly erased when the 42nd Amendment extension was struck down. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "It was wholly erased when the 42nd Amendment extension was struck down." fails against the controlling rule. This is the combined effect of Kesavananda Bharati (1973), Minerva Mills (1980) and Property Owners Association (2024).

C. It prevents courts from examining whether a law genuinely implements Article 39(b) or (c). - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "It prevents courts from examining whether a law genuinely implements Article 39(b) or (c)." fails against the controlling rule. This is the combined effect of Kesavananda Bharati (1973), Minerva Mills (1980) and Property Owners Association (2024).

D. It protects genuine Article 39(b)/(c) laws against Articles 14 and 19, while judicial review of the nexus and basic structure remains. - CORRECT: Correct: This is the combined effect of Kesavananda Bharati (1973), Minerva Mills (1980) and Property Owners Association (2024). This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Method / explanation: This is the combined effect of Kesavananda Bharati (1973), Minerva Mills (1980) and Property Owners Association (2024). This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Trap: Minerva Mills invalidated the all-DPSP extension of Article 31C, not the surviving Article 39(b)/(c) shield.

Q9. Answer: A | Polity

Consider the following statements: 1. Article 270 concerns distribution of specified Union taxes between Union and States. 2. Article 271 permits a Union-purpose surcharge whose whole proceeds form part of the Consolidated Fund of India. 3. Article 271 applies without qualification to GST under Article 246A. 4. Specific-purpose parliamentary cesses are excluded from the divisible pool under Article 270. Which are correct?

- A. 1, 2 and 4 only - CORRECT: Correct. Shared taxes, surcharges and specific-purpose cesses receive different constitutional treatment.
- B. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Statements 1 and 2 are true, but statement 4 is also a central divisible-pool distinction.
- C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Statement 3 ignores Article 271's express GST exclusion.
- D. 1, 3 and 4 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Statement 3 is false even though statements 1 and 4 correctly identify distribution and exclusion.

Method / explanation: Correct. Shared taxes, surcharges and specific-purpose cesses receive different constitutional treatment.

Trap: A high devolution percentage can coexist with a narrower shareable base; never equate divisible pool with gross Union tax revenue.

Q10. Answer: B | Polity

Consider the following statements on Article 252: 1. Resolutions of two or more State legislatures initiate the route. 2. The law automatically applies to all States. 3. Another State may later adopt the law. 4. A participating State may amend the law by its own legislation. Which are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Statement 2 is false because the enactment initially applies to the resolving States, not automatically to every State.
- B. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct. Two or more States initiate, and another State may adopt the parliamentary law later by resolution.
- C. 2 and 4 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Both statements 2 and 4 contradict the consent-based territorial design and Parliament's retained amendment power.
- D. 1, 3 and 4 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Statement 4 is false: amendment or repeal must be by Parliament in the like manner.

Method / explanation: Correct. Two or more States initiate, and another State may adopt the parliamentary law later by resolution.

Trap: Article 252 State consent expands Parliament's territory of operation but does not give participating States unilateral repeal power.

Q11. Answer: C | Polity

Article 214 and common courts Which statement is constitutionally correct?

- A. Every Union Territory must have an independent High Court. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. This formulation overstates, understates or misattributes the rule: Articles 214 and 231 must be read together; Article 232 is repealed and shared jurisdiction does not merge State services. Therefore 'Every Union Territory must have an independent High Court.' introduces a wrong actor, source, threshold, scope or consequence.
- B. Article 232 currently creates circuit benches. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. This choice conflicts with the controlling proposition: Articles 214 and 231 must be read together; Article 232 is repealed and shared jurisdiction does not merge State services. Therefore 'Article 232 currently creates circuit benches.' introduces a wrong actor, source, threshold, scope or consequence.
- C. Article 214's State-wise default operates with Article 231's power to establish a common High Court. - CORRECT: Correct. This option states the operative rule: Articles 214 and 231 must be read together; Article 232 is repealed and shared jurisdiction does not merge State services. Therefore 'Article 214's State-wise default operates with Article 231's power to establish a common High Court.' states the operative position.
- D. A common High Court merges the participating States' judicial services. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The option collapses a distinction preserved by the governing rule: Articles 214 and 231 must be read together; Article 232 is repealed and shared jurisdiction does not merge State services. Therefore 'A common High Court merges the participating States' judicial services.' introduces a wrong actor, source, threshold, scope or consequence.

Method / explanation: Correct. This option states the operative rule: Articles 214 and 231 must be read together; Article 232 is repealed and shared jurisdiction does not merge State services. Therefore 'Article 214's State-wise default operates with Article 231's power to establish a common High Court.' states the operative position.

Trap: The numerical phrase 'for each State' is a default, not a prohibition on common High Courts.

Q12. Answer: D | Polity

Which statement correctly distinguishes Article 40 and the 74th Amendment?

A. The 74th Amendment repealed Article 40. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "The 74th Amendment repealed Article 40." fails against the controlling rule. Local-government implementation overlaps, but the Article's exact text must be preserved.

B. Article 40 expressly directs creation of Municipalities. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "Article 40 expressly directs creation of Municipalities." fails against the controlling rule. Local-government implementation overlaps, but the Article's exact text must be preserved.

C. Article 40 applies only to Parliament and not States. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "Article 40 applies only to Parliament and not States." fails against the controlling rule. Local-government implementation overlaps, but the Article's exact text must be preserved.

D. Article 40 expressly concerns village panchayats; Municipalities are separately constitutionalised in Part IXA. - CORRECT: Correct: Local-government implementation overlaps, but the Article's exact text must be preserved. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Method / explanation: Local-government implementation overlaps, but the Article's exact text must be preserved. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Trap: Article 40 names village panchayats; municipalities have their separate Part IXA route.

Q13. Answer: A | Economy

Consider the following statements about India's Countercyclical Capital Buffer (CCyB): 1. RBI has a framework under which the buffer can be activated with systemic conditions. 2. The cited Basel III Master Circular of 1 April 2025 reported it as not activated. 3. It permanently replaces the Capital Conservation Buffer. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: RBI retains a CCyB framework but the cited circular reported no activation; it does not permanently replace the Capital Conservation Buffer.

B. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1 only does not satisfy the question's governing distinction. The tested rule instead is: RBI retains a CCyB framework but the cited circular reported no activation; it does not permanently replace the Capital Conservation Buffer.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 2 and 3 only does not satisfy the question's governing distinction. The tested rule instead is: RBI retains a CCyB framework but the cited circular reported no activation; it does not permanently replace the Capital Conservation Buffer.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1, 2 and 3 does not satisfy the question's governing distinction. The tested rule instead is: RBI retains a CCyB framework but the cited circular reported no activation; it does not permanently replace the Capital Conservation Buffer.

Method / explanation: RBI retains a CCyB framework but the cited circular reported no activation; it does not permanently replace the Capital Conservation Buffer.

Trap: A maximum framework value is not the same as the currently activated rate.

Q14. Answer: B | Economy

Consider the following general provisioning pairs under the RBI directions updated 1 July 2026: 1. Substandard asset - 15 per cent 2. Unsecured substandard exposure - 25 per cent 3. Loss asset retained in books - 100 per cent How many pairs are correctly matched?

A. Only one - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Only one does not satisfy the question's governing distinction. The tested rule instead is: All three pairs state the applicable general provisioning rates; identified loss retained in the books must be fully provided.

B. All three - CORRECT: Correct: All three pairs state the applicable general provisioning rates; identified loss retained in the books must be fully provided.

C. Only two - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Only two does not satisfy the question's governing distinction. The tested rule instead is: All three pairs state the applicable general provisioning rates; identified loss retained in the books must be fully provided.

D. None - INCORRECT: Incorrect: None does not satisfy the question's governing distinction. The tested rule instead is: All three pairs state the applicable general provisioning rates; identified loss retained in the books must be fully provided.

Method / explanation: All three pairs state the applicable general provisioning rates; identified loss retained in the books must be fully provided.

Trap: Special exposure-specific rules can qualify the general rates, but litigation does not suspend loss provisioning.

Q15. Answer: C | Economy

Which statement best explains economic incidence of a mandi fee?

A. The farmer necessarily bears exactly the stated rate. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Exact incidence cannot be assumed. The option states: The farmer necessarily bears exactly the stated rate.

B. The fee is always identical to commission. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Commission and statutory fee differ. The option states: The fee is always identical to commission.

C. The statutory payer may shift some burden through the bid, so legal liability and economic incidence can differ. - CORRECT: Correct: Bargaining and market structure shape burden sharing. The option states: The statutory payer may shift some burden through the bid, so legal liability and economic incidence can differ.

D. The fee is a central MSP deduction fixed nationwide. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: APMC charges are State-law instruments, not MSP. The option states: The fee is a central MSP deduction fixed nationwide.

Method / explanation: Bargaining and market structure shape burden sharing. The option states: The statutory payer may shift some burden through the bid, so legal liability and economic incidence can differ.

Trap: Statutory payer is not always the final bearer.

Q16. Answer: D | Economy

Under RBI's NDS-OM Directions dated 7 February 2025 and updated 27 April 2026, consider: 1. Direct access settles in the participant's own SGL account. 2. Indirect access uses another entity that assumes settlement responsibility. 3. Stock Broker Connect can provide access to individual demat clients. How many statements are correct?

A. Only one - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Both indirect access and Stock Broker Connect are expressly defined in the updated directions.

B. Only two - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Each statement accurately describes a separate NDS-OM access route.

C. None - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The directions define all three mechanisms and their settlement relationships.

D. All three - CORRECT: Correct: All three statements reflect the expanded access architecture in the current dated NDS-OM Directions.

Method / explanation: All three statements reflect the expanded access architecture in the current dated NDS-OM Directions.

Trap: NDS-OM access does not make the platform a depository or the investor a direct settlement member.

Q17. Answer: A | Economy

Consider the following statements: 1. QIP is undertaken by a listed issuer. 2. QIP places eligible securities with Qualified Institutional Buyers. 3. Every private placement is a QIP. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: SEBI's ICDR framework defines QIP as a listed-issuer placement of eligible securities to QIBs.

B. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: QIB eligibility is an essential part of the QIP definition.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 1 is correct, while statement 3 wrongly converts a species into the entire genus.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Private placement includes routes other than QIP, so statement 3 is overbroad.

Method / explanation: SEBI's ICDR framework defines QIP as a listed-issuer placement of eligible securities to QIBs.

Trap: QIP, preferential issue and general private placement are not interchangeable labels.

Q18. Answer: B | Economy

Consider the following statements about agricultural NPA recognition: 1. A short-duration crop advance becomes NPA when overdue for two crop seasons. 2. A long-duration crop advance becomes NPA when overdue for one crop season. 3. A fall in crop prices by itself classifies every farm advance as NPA. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1 only does not satisfy the question's governing distinction. The tested rule instead is: The current RBI framework uses two crop seasons for short-duration crops and one for long-duration crops; a price fall alone is not the recognition test.

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: The current RBI framework uses two crop seasons for short-duration crops and one for long-duration crops; a price fall alone is not the recognition test.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 2 and 3 only does not satisfy the question's governing distinction. The tested rule instead is: The current RBI framework uses two crop seasons for short-duration crops and one for long-duration crops; a price fall alone is not the recognition test.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1, 2 and 3 does not satisfy the question's governing distinction. The tested rule instead is: The current RBI framework uses two crop seasons for short-duration crops and one for long-duration crops; a price fall alone is not the recognition test.

Method / explanation: The current RBI framework uses two crop seasons for short-duration crops and one for long-duration crops; a price fall alone is not the recognition test.

Trap: Crop-season rules are product-specific exceptions to the common 90-day shorthand.

Q19. Answer: C | Economy

Consider the following statements about a covered Basic Savings Bank Deposit account under RBI's amendment effective 1 April 2026: 1. No minimum balance is required for the prescribed basic facilities. 2. At least four withdrawals a month are free under the listed basic service. 3. Every holder receives an automatic Rs 10,000 loan. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1 only does not satisfy the question's governing distinction. The tested rule instead is: The dated BSBD framework provides no-minimum-balance basic service and at least four free withdrawals a month; it does not create an automatic loan entitlement.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 2 and 3 only does not satisfy the question's governing distinction. The tested rule instead is: The dated BSBD framework provides no-minimum-balance basic service and at least four free withdrawals a month; it does not create an automatic loan entitlement.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: The dated BSBD framework provides no-minimum-balance basic service and at least four free withdrawals a month; it does not create an automatic loan entitlement.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: 1, 2 and 3 does not satisfy the question's governing distinction. The tested rule instead is: The dated BSBD framework provides no-minimum-balance basic service and at least four free withdrawals a month; it does not create an automatic loan entitlement.

Method / explanation: The dated BSBD framework provides no-minimum-balance basic service and at least four free withdrawals a month; it does not create an automatic loan entitlement.

Trap: BSBD and PMJDY overlap in inclusion purpose but are not identical labels.

Q20. Answer: D | Economy

Consider the following pairs under the RBI Certificate of Deposit Directions dated 4 June 2021: 1. Minimum denomination - Rs 5 lakh 2. Issuance tenor for a bank CD - seven days to one year 3. Primary issue settlement - T+1 How many pairs are correctly matched?

A. Only one - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Both the tenor and primary-settlement pairs are also stated in the 2021 Directions.

B. Only two - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The denomination, tenor and T+1 primary issuance rules are all correctly paired.

C. None - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Each pair reproduces a distinct requirement of the current dated CD framework.

D. All three - CORRECT: Correct: All three pairs match the RBI CD Directions; CDs must also be issued in dematerialised form.

Method / explanation: All three pairs match the RBI CD Directions; CDs must also be issued in dematerialised form.

Trap: A bank CD is negotiable and unsecured, but it is not an ordinary withdrawable savings deposit.

Q21. Answer: A | Economy

Consider the following regulatory map: 1. SEBI - domestic listed securities, mutual funds and AIFs 2. RBI - specified OTC interest-rate and foreign-exchange derivatives 3. PFRDA - National Pension System 4. IFSCA - financial products and institutions in an IFSC Which option is correct?

A. 1, 2, 3 and 4 - CORRECT: Correct: All four matches are correct, subject to statutory overlap and cross-border coordination.

B. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: PFRDA and IFSCA also have the stated specialised jurisdictions.

C. 1, 3 and 4 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: RBI's functional perimeter includes specified OTC rate and currency derivatives.

D. 2, 3 and 4 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: SEBI is the principal domestic securities and fund-market regulator.

Method / explanation: All four matches are correct, subject to statutory overlap and cross-border coordination.

Trap: Regulator mapping follows product, activity, entity and location rather than one universal label.

Q22. Answer: B | Economy

Which statement about preference shares is correct? 1. They carry preferential dividend and capital-repayment rights over ordinary equity. 2. They are legally share capital. 3. They always rank ahead of secured creditors.

- A. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 2 is also correct despite debt-like economic features.
- B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: Preference shares combine preferential economic rights with legal equity status.
- C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 1 is correct, while creditor priority ordinarily precedes preference capital.
- D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 3 wrongly places share capital above secured creditor claims.

Method / explanation: Preference shares combine preferential economic rights with legal equity status.

Trap: Fixed-looking preference dividends do not automatically make the instrument a bond.

Q23. Answer: C | Economy

Which statement best defines MSP?

- A. It is a statutory monthly income paid to every farmer. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Income support is a different instrument. The option states: It is a statutory monthly income paid to every farmer.
- B. It is FCI's total economic cost. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Economic cost includes acquisition and distribution components. The option states: It is FCI's total economic cost.
- C. It is a pre-season administered price signal for specified crops, not automatic universal purchase. - CORRECT: Correct: The definition preserves crop, season and procurement boundaries. The option states: It is a pre-season administered price signal for specified crops, not automatic universal purchase.
- D. It is the retail price charged at every fair-price shop. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: PDS issue policy is separate from farm price policy. The option states: It is the retail price charged at every fair-price shop.

Method / explanation: The definition preserves crop, season and procurement boundaries. The option states: It is a pre-season administered price signal for specified crops, not automatic universal purchase.

Trap: Announcement does not prove procurement.

Q24. Answer: D | Economy

Consider the following statements about Primary Dealers: 1. They support government-security auctions through bidding or underwriting obligations. 2. They support secondary-market liquidity through market making. 3. They guarantee that every G-Sec investor avoids market loss. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Market making is also a central dealer function in the secondary G-Sec market.
- B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Underwriting is a primary-market role, while statement 3 invents a price guarantee.
- C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: PD participation cannot eliminate interest-rate or liquidity loss for investors.
- D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: RBI's PD framework joins primary-auction commitment with secondary market-making, not investor-return insurance.

Method / explanation: RBI's PD framework joins primary-auction commitment with secondary market-making, not investor-return insurance.

Trap: RBI authorisation does not make a PD the sovereign issuer.

Q25. Answer: A | Ancient History

Consider the following statements: 1. Standard weights and scales support the inference of regular measurement in exchange. 2. Their use proves that Harappans used minted coinage. 3. Weights can be discussed with seals and craft production as parts of an integrated economy. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: Statements 1 and 3 connect measurement to production and exchange. No coinage is known, so statement 2 substitutes a later economic form for the actual evidence.
- B. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "1 only" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that statements 1 and 3 connect measurement to production and exchange. No coinage is known, so statement 2 substitutes a later economic form for the actual evidence.
- C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "2 and 3 only" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that statements 1 and 3 connect measurement to production and exchange. No coinage is known, so statement 2 substitutes a later economic form for the actual evidence.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "1, 2 and 3" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that statements 1 and 3 connect measurement to production and exchange. No coinage is known, so statement 2 substitutes a later economic form for the actual evidence.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 3 connect measurement to production and exchange. No coinage is known, so statement 2 substitutes a later economic form for the actual evidence.

Trap: Weights are evidence of metrology, not minted coinage.

Q26. Answer: B | Ancient History

With reference to Harappan chronology, consider the following statements: 1. The Mature Harappan phase is conventionally placed c. 2600-1900 BCE. 2. The Early Harappan phase represents regional and proto-urban development. 3. The Late Harappan phase is best treated as an interval without settlement continuity. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "1 and 3 only" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that statements 1 and 2 fit the process model. Statement 3 fails because Late Harappan communities and regional traditions continued even as urban integration changed.

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: Statements 1 and 2 fit the process model. Statement 3 fails because Late Harappan communities and regional traditions continued even as urban integration changed.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "1, 2 and 3" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that statements 1 and 2 fit the process model. Statement 3 fails because Late Harappan communities and regional traditions continued even as urban integration changed.

D. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "2 and 3 only" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that statements 1 and 2 fit the process model. Statement 3 fails because Late Harappan communities and regional traditions continued even as urban integration changed.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 fit the process model. Statement 3 fails because Late Harappan communities and regional traditions continued even as urban integration changed.

Trap: Treat phase labels as archaeological processes, not ethnic replacements.

Q27. Answer: C | Ancient History

Consider the following site-feature pairs: 1. Mohenjo-daro - Great Bath 2. Kalibangan - ploughed-field evidence 3. Chanhudaro - specialised craft production How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

A. Only two - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "Only two" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that all three are high-yield associations. Their value lies in the pair: Mohenjo-daro-water structure, Kalibangan-farming surface and Chanhudaro-craft, not in a detached site list.

B. Only one - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "Only one" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that all three are high-yield associations. Their value lies in the pair: Mohenjo-daro-water structure, Kalibangan-farming surface and Chanhudaro-craft, not in a detached site list.

C. All three - CORRECT: Correct: All three are high-yield associations. Their value lies in the pair: Mohenjo-daro-water structure, Kalibangan-farming surface and Chanhudaro-craft, not in a detached site list.

D. None - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "None" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that all three are high-yield associations. Their value lies in the pair: Mohenjo-daro-water structure, Kalibangan-farming surface and Chanhudaro-craft, not in a detached site list.

Method / explanation: All three are high-yield associations. Their value lies in the pair: Mohenjo-daro-water structure, Kalibangan-farming surface and Chanhudaro-craft, not in a detached site list.

Trap: A three-pair question is lost by one swapped site-feature association.

Q28. Answer: D | Ancient History

Consider the following statements about social inference: 1. Variation in house size may suggest unequal access to resources. 2. House size alone proves a fixed caste system. 3. Burial and household evidence require context and comparison before social conclusions are drawn. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "1, 2 and 3" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that variation may support a cautious inequality inference, and context is essential. A fixed caste system cannot be read directly from house size or burial variation.

B. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "1 only" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that variation may support a cautious inequality inference, and context is essential. A fixed caste system cannot be read directly from house size or

burial variation.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "2 and 3 only" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that variation may support a cautious inequality inference, and context is essential. A fixed caste system cannot be read directly from house size or burial variation.

D. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: Variation may support a cautious inequality inference, and context is essential. A fixed caste system cannot be read directly from house size or burial variation.

Method / explanation: Variation may support a cautious inequality inference, and context is essential. A fixed caste system cannot be read directly from house size or burial variation.

Trap: House size and grave goods suggest difference but do not directly prove caste.

Q29. Answer: A | Medieval History

With reference to India on the Eve of the Medieval Age & Arab-Turkish Contacts, consider the following statements: 1. Satish Chandra stresses that Arab traders revived and strengthened India's sea trade with West Asia and other countries after overland routes had been affected. 2. Arab traders settled in Malabar; the Rashtrakuta rulers welcomed them and permitted mosques for worship. 3. Arab conquest of Sind immediately led to the Delhi Sultanate. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about India on the Eve of the Medieval Age & Arab-Turkish Contacts; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: The Sultanate came much later through Turkish-Ghurid expansion.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Arab conquest of Sind immediately led to the Delhi Sultanate.' and replaces it with 'The Sultanate came much later through Turkish-Ghurid expansion.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Arab conquest of Sind immediately led to the Delhi Sultanate.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: The Sultanate came much later through Turkish-Ghurid expansion.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: The Sultanate came much later through Turkish-Ghurid expansion.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Arab conquest of Sind immediately led to the Delhi Sultanate. -> The Sultanate came much later through Turkish-Ghurid expansion.

Q30. Answer: B | Medieval History

With reference to The Ghaznavids & the Ghurian Invasions, consider the following statements: 1. The conventional textbook count assigns Mahmud seventeen Indian expeditions, but the counting of separate operations is not uniform; the secure point is his repeated raiding between 1000 and 1027. 2. His early wars were against the Hindu Shahis of Peshawar/Punjab; Jayapala and Anandapala offered prolonged resistance. 3. Jaichandra's absence at Tarain is proved only by the Sanyogita legend. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Jaichandra's absence at Tarain is proved only by the Sanyogita legend.' and replaces it with 'Satish Chandra treats the romance cautiously and points to older political rivalry.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Ghaznavids & the Ghurian Invasions; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Satish Chandra treats the romance cautiously and points to older political rivalry.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Jaichandra's absence at Tarain is proved only by the Sanyogita legend.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Satish Chandra treats the romance cautiously and points to older political rivalry.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Satish Chandra treats the romance cautiously and points to older political rivalry.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Jaichandra's absence at Tarain is proved only by the Sanyogita legend. -> Satish Chandra treats the romance cautiously and points to older political rivalry.

Q31. Answer: C | Medieval History

With reference to Foundation of the Delhi Sultanate: The Slave (Mamluk) Dynasty, consider the following statements: 1. Qutbuddin Aibak was Muizzuddin's Turkish slave and an important commander after Tarain; in 1206 he ruled from Lahore and severed links with Ghazni. 2. Aibak's brief reign mattered because it prevented Delhi from being drawn into Central Asian politics and allowed the Sultanate to develop in India. 3. The Mongols crossed and conquered Delhi under Ilutmish. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The Mongols crossed and conquered Delhi under Ilutmish.' and replaces it with 'Chingez reached the Indus but did not invade Delhi.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The Mongols crossed and conquered Delhi under Ilutmish.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Foundation of the Delhi Sultanate: The Slave (Mamluk) Dynasty; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Chingez reached the Indus but did not invade Delhi.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Chingez reached the Indus but did not invade Delhi.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Chingez reached the Indus but did not invade Delhi.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Mongols crossed and conquered Delhi under Ilutmish. -> Chingez reached the Indus but did not invade Delhi.

Q32. Answer: D | Medieval History

With reference to The Khaljis: Alauddin Khalji & Market Reforms, consider the following statements: 1. Alauddin faced repeated Mongol invasions of Delhi, which forced him to raise and pay a large standing army. 2. Cheap grain supply: land revenue in the doab (Meerut to Kara) was taken directly by the state (no iqta assignment), assessed at half (50%) of the produce. It was calculated in kind and generally demanded in cash, while areas near Delhi also supplied a portion in kind for royal stores. 3. The reforms applied across the whole empire. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The reforms applied across the whole empire.' and replaces it with 'Price control was centred on Delhi; the doab revenue measure fed the capital's grain supply.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The reforms applied across the whole empire.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Price control was centred on Delhi; the doab revenue measure fed the capital's grain supply.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Khaljis: Alauddin Khalji & Market Reforms; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Price control was centred on Delhi; the doab revenue measure fed the capital's grain supply.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Price control was centred on Delhi; the doab revenue measure fed the capital's grain supply.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The reforms applied across the whole empire. -> Price control was centred on Delhi; the doab revenue measure fed the capital's grain supply.

Q33. Answer: A | Modern History

With reference to The Decline of the Mughal Empire (1707-1740s), consider the following statements: 1. Aurangzeb's death in 1707 was followed by wars of succession and a rapid weakening of central authority; weak successors could not hold the vast empire together. 2. Bahadur Shah I (1707-12) followed a policy of compromise with Marathas, Rajputs and Sikhs, but reversed nothing fundamental; after him a series of weak rulers depended on powerful nobles. 3. Nadir Shah established Persian rule in India. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Decline of the Mughal Empire (1707-1740s); statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: He plundered and left; he did not annex the empire.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Nadir Shah established Persian rule in India.' and replaces it with 'He plundered and left; he did not annex the empire.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Nadir Shah established Persian rule in India.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: He plundered and left; he did not annex the empire.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: He plundered and left; he did not annex the empire.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Nadir Shah established Persian rule in India. -> He plundered and left; he did not annex the empire.

Q34. Answer: B | Modern History

With reference to Indian States & Society in the Eighteenth Century, consider the following statements: 1. After Mughal decline, power shifted to regional states: Bengal, Awadh, Hyderabad, Marathas, Sikhs, Jats, Mysore, Rajput states and Kerala/Travancore. 2. Bipin Chandra groups these states into successor states, new/rebel states, and independent kingdoms. 3. Marathas were a single centralised state under the Peshwa. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Marathas were a single centralised state under the Peshwa.' and replaces it with 'They evolved into a confederacy with powerful chiefs.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Indian States & Society in the Eighteenth Century; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: They evolved into a confederacy with powerful chiefs.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Marathas were a single centralised state under the Peshwa.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: They evolved into a confederacy with powerful chiefs.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: They evolved into a confederacy with powerful chiefs.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Marathas were a single centralised state under the Peshwa. -> They evolved into a confederacy with powerful chiefs.

Q35. Answer: C | Modern History

With reference to The Beginnings of European Settlements, consider the following statements: 1. The Portuguese arrived first by sea when Vasco da Gama reached Calicut in 1498. 2. Portuguese power rested on naval control, fortified ports, the cartaz pass system and the Estado da India centred on Goa. 3. The Dutch were the main political rivals of the English in 18th-century India. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The Dutch were the main political rivals of the English in 18th-century India.' and replaces it with 'The French were the main rival in the Carnatic Wars.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The Dutch were the main political rivals of the English in 18th-century India.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Beginnings of European Settlements; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: The French were the main rival in the Carnatic Wars.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: The French were the main rival in the Carnatic Wars.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: The French were the main rival in the Carnatic Wars.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Dutch were the main political rivals of the English in 18th-century India. -> The French were the main rival in the Carnatic Wars.

Q36. Answer: D | Modern History

With reference to The British Conquest of Bengal (Plassey & Buxar), consider the following statements: 1. Bengal was one of the richest Mughal provinces, with fertile agriculture, textile production and active trade. 2. Murshid Quli Khan, Alivardi Khan and Siraj-ud-Daula made Bengal autonomous in practice while still linked to Mughal legitimacy. 3. The Black Hole episode alone caused the conflict. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The Black Hole episode alone caused the conflict.' and replaces it with 'The deeper causes were trade privileges, fortification and Company private trade.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The Black Hole episode alone caused the conflict.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: The deeper causes were trade privileges, fortification and Company private trade.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The British Conquest of Bengal (Plassey & Buxar); statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: The deeper causes were trade privileges, fortification and Company private trade.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: The deeper causes were trade privileges, fortification and Company private trade.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Black Hole episode alone caused the conflict. -> The deeper causes were trade privileges, fortification and Company private trade.

Q37. Answer: A | Modern History

With reference to British Territorial Expansion (Mysore, Marathas, Sikhs), consider the following statements: 1. After Bengal, the Company used revenue, armies and alliances to defeat Mysore, Marathas and Sikhs. 2. Mysore under Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan was a major southern opponent because it tried to modernise its army and resist Company control. 3. Awadh was annexed by Doctrine of Lapse. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about British Territorial Expansion (Mysore, Marathas, Sikhs); statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Awadh was annexed in 1856 for alleged misgovernance.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Awadh was annexed by Doctrine of Lapse.' and replaces it with 'Awadh was annexed in 1856 for alleged misgovernance.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Awadh was annexed by Doctrine of Lapse.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Awadh was annexed in 1856 for alleged misgovernance.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Awadh was annexed in 1856 for alleged misgovernance.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Awadh was annexed by Doctrine of Lapse. -> Awadh was annexed in 1856 for alleged misgovernance.

Q38. Answer: B | Modern History

With reference to Structure of Government & Constitutional Development, 1757-1858, consider the following statements: 1. After Plassey (1757) and Buxar (1764), the East India Company was no longer only a trading body; with the Diwani of Bengal (1765) it controlled revenue and had to be regulated as a political power. 2. The early constitutional acts were Parliament's response to Company misrule, financial crisis and the need to make a private corporation answerable for governing Indian territories. 3. Charter Act 1853 by itself instantly created the competitive examination. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Charter Act 1853 by itself instantly created the competitive examination.' and replaces it with 'It removed patronage and authorised competition; the 1854 committee and 1855 examination were separate implementation steps.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Structure of Government & Constitutional Development, 1757-1858; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It removed patronage and authorised competition; the 1854 committee and 1855 examination were separate implementation steps.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Charter Act 1853 by itself instantly created the competitive examination.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It removed patronage and authorised competition; the 1854 committee and 1855 examination were separate implementation steps.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It removed patronage and authorised competition; the 1854 committee and 1855 examination were separate implementation steps.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Charter Act 1853 by itself instantly created the competitive examination. -> It removed patronage and authorised competition; the 1854 committee and 1855 examination were separate implementation steps.

Q39. Answer: C | Art and Culture

Which stupa part-function pair is correctly matched?

A. Harmika - ground-level ambulatory path - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Harmika is the summit railing, vedika marks the sacred boundary, and chattra is the honour-bearing umbrella form. The option tested was 'Harmika - ground-level ambulatory path'.

B. Vedika - relic deposited inside the mound - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Harmika is the summit railing, vedika marks the sacred boundary, and chattra is the honour-bearing umbrella form. The option tested was 'Vedika - relic deposited inside the mound'.

C. Torana - ceremonial gateway carrying narrative or decorative emphasis - CORRECT: Correct: Harmika is the summit railing, vedika marks the sacred boundary, and chattra is the honour-bearing umbrella form. The option tested was 'Torana - ceremonial gateway carrying narrative or decorative emphasis'.

D. Chattra - stone railing around the lower terrace - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Harmika is the summit railing, vedika marks the sacred boundary, and chattra is the honour-bearing umbrella form. The option tested was 'Chattra - stone railing around the lower terrace'.

Method / explanation: Harmika is the summit railing, vedika marks the sacred boundary, and chattra is the honour-bearing umbrella form. The option tested was 'Torana - ceremonial gateway carrying narrative or decorative emphasis'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q40. Answer: D | Art and Culture

Which statement best explains why temples matter beyond ritual?

A. Temples were only spaces of worship and cannot reveal political or social history. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: temple evidence works precisely by combining ritual, patronage, administration, labour and selective social representation in one durable institution. The option tested was 'Temples were only spaces of worship and cannot reveal political or social history'.

B. Temples matter because they collapse all evidence into religion alone. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: temple evidence works precisely by combining ritual, patronage, administration, labour and selective social representation in one durable institution. The option tested was 'Temples matter because they collapse all evidence into religion alone'.

C. Temples can replace every other source and should be treated as full social censuses. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: temple evidence works precisely by combining ritual, patronage, administration, labour and selective social representation in one durable institution. The option tested was 'Temples can replace every other source and should be treated as full social censuses'.

D. Temples record ritual, patronage, economic support, craft organisation, festivals and selected social representation in one durable institution. - CORRECT: Correct: temple evidence works precisely by combining ritual, patronage, administration, labour and selective social representation in one durable institution. The option tested was 'Temples record ritual, patronage, economic support, craft organisation, festivals and selected social representation in one durable institution'.

Method / explanation: temple evidence works precisely by combining ritual, patronage, administration, labour and selective social representation in one durable institution. The option tested was 'Temples record ritual, patronage, economic support, craft organisation, festivals and selected social representation in one durable institution'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q41. Answer: A | Art and Culture

Which statement best explains Vijayanagara temple planning?

A. Its temple complexes emphasize chariot streets, pillared mandapas and monumental gateways within a capital-wide sacred-royal landscape. - CORRECT: Correct: The source supports this exact identification. The option tested was 'Its temple complexes emphasize chariot streets, pillared mandapas and monumental gateways within a capital-wide sacred-royal landscape'.

B. Vijayanagara architecture is entirely identical to Hoysala stellate soapstone temples. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'Vijayanagara architecture is entirely identical to Hoysala stellate soapstone temples'.

C. Its main monuments are all rock-cut caves of the Mauryan age. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'Its main monuments are all rock-cut caves of the Mauryan age'.

D. The tradition rejected all earlier South Indian influences. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'The tradition rejected all earlier South Indian influences'.

Method / explanation: The source supports this exact identification. The option tested was 'Its temple complexes emphasize chariot streets, pillared mandapas and monumental gateways within a capital-wide sacred-royal landscape'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q42. Answer: B | Art and Culture

Which monument-feature pair is correctly matched?

A. Virupaksha, Hampi - queen Lokmahadevi's 8th-century Chalukya victory temple - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'Virupaksha, Hampi - queen Lokmahadevi's 8th-century Chalukya victory temple'.

B. Vitthala, Hampi - stone chariot and musical-pillar fame within a Vijayanagara temple complex - CORRECT: Correct: The source supports this exact identification. The option tested was 'Vitthala, Hampi - stone chariot and musical-pillar fame within a Vijayanagara temple complex'.

temple complex'.

C. Mahanavami Dibba - principal sanctum of the Virupaksha temple - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'Mahanavami Dibba - principal sanctum of the Virupaksha temple'.

D. Lotus Mahal - granite Nagara shikhara of a Chandella shrine - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'Lotus Mahal - granite Nagara shikhara of a Chandella shrine'.

Method / explanation: The source supports this exact identification. The option tested was 'Vitthala, Hampi - stone chariot and musical-pillar fame within a Vijayanagara temple complex'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q43. Answer: C | Art and Culture

Which statement uses material as a chronology marker most carefully?

A. All Mughal phases used the same material logic, so chronology cannot be inferred from surface treatment. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: it preserves phased material change without making it absolute. The option tested was 'All Mughal phases used the same material logic, so chronology cannot be inferred from surface treatment.'.

B. White marble is a safe marker of every pre-Mughal building. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'White marble is a safe marker of every pre-Mughal building.'.

C. Akbar is associated with red sandstone scale, Jahangir-Nur Jahan with the white-marble turn, and Shah Jahan with marble refinement across tomb, fort and mosque. - CORRECT: Correct: The source supports this exact identification. The option tested was 'Akbar is associated with red sandstone scale, Jahangir-Nur Jahan with the white-marble turn, and Shah Jahan with marble refinement across tomb, fort and mosque.'.

D. Tughlaq architecture is best dated through pietra dura alone. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'Tughlaq architecture is best dated through pietra dura alone.'.

Method / explanation: The source supports this exact identification. The option tested was 'Akbar is associated with red sandstone scale, Jahangir-Nur Jahan with the white-marble turn, and Shah Jahan with marble refinement across tomb, fort and mosque.'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q44. Answer: D | Art and Culture

Which statement best explains why cinema belongs in the art-and-culture syllabus?

A. Cinema is only a branch of theatre because both use acting. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: it captures both composite form and modern circulation, which is the central thesis of Topic 15. The option tested was 'Cinema is only a branch of theatre because both use acting.'.

B. Cinema belongs only to Economy because tickets are sold in markets. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: it captures both composite form and modern circulation, which is the central thesis of Topic 15. The option tested was 'Cinema belongs only to Economy because tickets are sold in markets.'.

C. Cinema can be studied only through award lists. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: it captures both composite form and modern circulation, which is the central thesis of Topic 15. The remaining options confuse chronology, institution, category, medium or current-status discipline. The option tested was 'Cinema can be studied only through award lists.'.

D. Cinema combines narrative, performance, moving image, sound and editing, then adds reproducibility and mass circulation as a modern art form. - CORRECT: Correct: it captures both composite form and modern circulation, which is the central thesis of Topic 15. The option tested was 'Cinema combines narrative, performance, moving image, sound and editing, then adds reproducibility and mass circulation as a modern art form.'.

Method / explanation: it captures both composite form and modern circulation, which is the central thesis of Topic 15. The option tested was 'Cinema combines narrative, performance, moving image, sound and editing, then adds reproducibility and mass circulation as a modern art form.'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q45. Answer: A | Geography

With reference to The Earth and the Universe, consider the following statements: 1. Earth's geometric approximation = oblate spheroid; geoid = gravity-defined mean-sea-level surface. 2. International Date Line 180 meridian. 3. P-waves cannot travel through liquids. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Earth and the Universe; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: S-waves can't; P-waves travel through solids and liquids.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'P-waves cannot travel through liquids.' and replaces it with 'S-waves can't; P-waves travel through solids and liquids.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: P-waves cannot travel through liquids.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: S-waves can't; P-waves travel through solids and liquids.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: S-waves can't; P-waves travel through solids and liquids.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: P-waves cannot travel through liquids. -> S-waves can't; P-waves travel through solids and liquids.

Q46. Answer: B | Geography

With reference to The Earths Crust Rocks, consider the following statements: 1. Plutonic (intrusive) rocks cool slowly deep in the crust -> large, easily recognised crystals (granite); exposed later by denudation. 2. Volcanic (extrusive) rocks pour out as lava and solidify fast -> tiny crystals; basalt forms lava sheets/plateaux (Deccan, Columbia-Snake, Iceland). 3. Source rock of every metamorphic rock is obvious. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Source rock of every metamorphic rock is obvious.' and replaces it with 'For quartzite/marble it is clear; for schist and gneiss the parent is often hard to determine.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Earths Crust Rocks; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: For quartzite/marble it is clear; for schist and gneiss the parent is often hard to determine.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Source rock of every metamorphic rock is obvious.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: For quartzite/marble it is clear; for schist and gneiss the parent is often hard to determine.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: For quartzite/marble it is clear; for schist and gneiss the parent is often hard to determine.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Source rock of every metamorphic rock is obvious. -> For quartzite/marble it is clear; for schist and gneiss the parent is often hard to determine.

Q47. Answer: C | Geography

With reference to Vulcanism and Earthquakes, consider the following statements: 1. Shield (lava dome) volcanoes form from fluid basic (basaltic) lava that spreads far -> gentle slopes and wide lava sheets. 2. Acid lava cones form from viscous lava that cannot flow far -> steep-sided cones. 3. Any volcano without a recorded historic eruption is extinct. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Any volcano without a recorded historic eruption is extinct.' and replaces it with 'Activity status uses geological and geophysical evidence; a long-quiescent volcano may still be dormant.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Any volcano without a recorded historic eruption is extinct.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Vulcanism and Earthquakes; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Activity status uses geological and geophysical evidence; a long-quiescent volcano may still be dormant.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Activity status uses geological and geophysical evidence; a long-quiescent volcano may still be dormant.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Activity status uses geological and geophysical evidence; a long-quiescent volcano may still be dormant.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Any volcano without a recorded historic eruption is extinct. -> Activity status uses geological and geophysical evidence; a long-quiescent volcano may still be dormant.

Q48. Answer: D | Geography

With reference to Weathering, Mass Movement & Groundwater, consider the following statements: 1. Exfoliation: outer rock heats and peels off in thin layers like an onion; angular debris collects as scree at cliff foot. 2. Frost action: water expands by about 9% on freezing and can prise apart jointed, saturated rock. 3. Chemical weathering is strongest in cold dry climates. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Chemical weathering is strongest in cold dry climates.' and replaces it with 'It is strongest in hot-humid climates; cold/high-altitude zones favour physical (frost) weathering.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Chemical weathering is strongest in cold dry climates.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It is strongest in hot-humid climates; cold/high-altitude zones favour physical (frost) weathering.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Weathering, Mass Movement & Groundwater; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It is strongest in hot-humid climates; cold/high-altitude zones favour physical (frost) weathering.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It is strongest in hot-humid climates; cold/high-altitude zones favour physical (frost) weathering.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Chemical weathering is strongest in cold dry climates. -> It is strongest in hot-humid climates; cold/high-altitude zones favour physical (frost) weathering.

Q49. Answer: A | Geography

With reference to Landforms by Running Water, consider the following statements: 1. Upper course: swift descent, rapid down-cutting -> deep, narrow V-shaped valley; hard-rock bands give rapids and waterfalls; spurs interlock. 2. Middle course: gradient eases; vertical corrasion nearly ceases, lateral corrasion widens the valley; the river swings in meanders and cuts river cliffs. 3. V-shaped valleys and U-shaped valleys are both made by rivers. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Landforms by Running Water; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Rivers cut V-shaped valleys; U-shaped valleys are glacial.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'V-shaped valleys and U-shaped valleys are both made by rivers.' and replaces it with 'Rivers cut V-shaped valleys; U-shaped valleys are glacial.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: V-shaped valleys and U-shaped valleys are both made by rivers.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Rivers cut V-shaped valleys; U-shaped valleys are glacial.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Rivers cut V-shaped valleys; U-shaped valleys are glacial.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: V-shaped valleys and U-shaped valleys are both made by rivers. -> Rivers cut V-shaped valleys; U-shaped valleys are glacial.

Q50. Answer: B | Geography

With reference to Landforms of Glaciation, consider the following statements: 1. Cirque (corrie/cwm): plucking on the back-wall + abrasion of the floor deepen a horse-shoe basin; a small lake in it is a tarn. 2. Arete = sharp ridge separating two cirques ('fish-bone'); where three or more cirques meet, a pyramidal horn forms (classic: Matterhorn). 3. The Ganga rises at Gangotri town. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The Ganga rises at Gangotri town.' and replaces it with 'The Bhagirathi emerges from the GOMUKH snout of the Gangotri glacier.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Landforms of Glaciation; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: The Bhagirathi emerges from the GOMUKH snout of the Gangotri glacier.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The Ganga rises at Gangotri town.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: The Bhagirathi emerges from the GOMUKH snout of the Gangotri glacier.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: The Bhagirathi emerges from the GOMUKH snout of the Gangotri glacier.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Ganga rises at Gangotri town. -> The Bhagirathi emerges from the GOMUKH snout of the Gangotri glacier.

Q51. Answer: C | Geography

With reference to Arid Desert Landforms, consider the following statements: 1. Deflation lowers the land into deflation hollows by blowing away loose sand/dust; a lag of pebbles left behind forms a desert pavement. 2. Abrasion and deflation help sculpt zeugens (tabular, resistant cap rock over a narrower softer pedestal), pedestal/mushroom rocks and yardangs (streamlined ridges parallel to prevailing wind). 3. A yardang's long axis is perpendicular to the wind. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A yardang's long axis is perpendicular to the wind.' and replaces it with 'A yardang is streamlined PARALLEL to the wind direction.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A yardang's long axis is perpendicular to the wind.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Arid Desert Landforms; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: A yardang is streamlined PARALLEL to the wind direction.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: A yardang is streamlined PARALLEL to the wind direction.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: A yardang is streamlined PARALLEL to the wind direction.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A yardang's long axis is perpendicular to the wind. -> A yardang is streamlined PARALLEL to the wind direction.

Q52. Answer: D | Geography

With reference to Limestone and Karst Landforms, consider the following statements: 1. Carbonation/solution of calcium carbonate is the dominant process; karst is dry at the surface and lacks a well-integrated drainage system (Majid). 2. Swallow holes/ponors are points where surface water sinks. Doline and sinkhole are overlapping terms for closed karst depressions; coalesced depressions may form uvalas, while poljes are much larger, structurally influenced, flat-floored basins. 3. Karst aquifers are well protected from contamination. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Karst aquifers are well protected from contamination.' and replaces it with 'They are HIGHLY vulnerable - pollutants travel fast through open joints/caves.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Karst aquifers are well protected from contamination.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: They are HIGHLY vulnerable - pollutants travel fast through open joints/caves.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Limestone and Karst Landforms; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: They are HIGHLY vulnerable - pollutants travel fast through open joints/caves.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: They are HIGHLY vulnerable - pollutants travel fast through open joints/caves.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Karst aquifers are well protected from contamination. -> They are HIGHLY vulnerable - pollutants travel fast through open joints/caves.

Q53. Answer: A | Geography

With reference to Lakes: Formation & Types, consider the following statements: 1. Lake = water body in a land hollow/depression. 2. Major origins: tectonic, glacial, volcanic/crater, erosional, depositional and man-made. 3. Caspian Sea is an ocean/sea because of its name. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Lakes: Formation & Types; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It is the world's largest lake, an inland tectonic basin.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Caspian Sea is an ocean/sea because of its name.' and replaces it with 'It is the world's largest lake, an inland tectonic basin.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Caspian Sea is an ocean/sea because of its name.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It is the world's largest lake, an inland tectonic basin.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It is the world's largest lake, an inland tectonic basin.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Caspian Sea is an ocean/sea because of its name. -> It is the world's largest lake, an inland tectonic basin.

Q54. Answer: B | Geography

With reference to Coastal Landforms, consider the following statements: 1. Erosional sequence: cave -> arch -> stack -> stump. 2. Wave-cut platform widens as the cliff retreats. 3. Emergent and submergent coasts are wave-energy classes. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Emergent and submergent coasts are wave-energy classes.' and replaces it with 'They are based on relative land/sea-level change.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Coastal Landforms; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: They are based on relative land/sea-level change.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Emergent and submergent coasts are wave-energy classes.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: They are based on relative land/sea-level change.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: They are based on relative land/sea-level change.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Emergent and submergent coasts are wave-energy classes. -> They are based on relative land/sea-level change.

Q55. Answer: C | Geography

With reference to Islands & Coral Reefs, consider the following statements: 1. Island types: continental, oceanic/volcanic and coral. 2. Coral polyps build limestone skeletons; zooxanthellae are symbiotic algae. 3. Corals thrive in cold, deep, muddy water. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Corals thrive in cold, deep, muddy water.' and replaces it with 'Corals need warm, shallow, clear, sediment-free saline water.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Corals thrive in cold, deep, muddy water.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Islands & Coral Reefs; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Corals need warm, shallow, clear, sediment-free saline water.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Corals need warm, shallow, clear, sediment-free saline water.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Corals need warm, shallow, clear, sediment-free saline water.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Corals thrive in cold, deep, muddy water. -> Corals need warm, shallow, clear, sediment-free saline water.

Q56. Answer: D | Geography

With reference to The Oceans: Currents, Tides & Salinity, consider the following statements: 1. Wind is the dominant driver of surface currents; density drives deep currents. 2. Warm current = poleward; cold current = equatorward. 3. Gyres rotate the same way in both hemispheres. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Gyres rotate the same way in both hemispheres.' and replaces it with 'Coriolis makes rotation clockwise in N, anticlockwise in S.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Gyres rotate the same way in both hemispheres.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Coriolis makes rotation clockwise in N, anticlockwise in S.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Oceans: Currents, Tides & Salinity; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Coriolis makes rotation clockwise in N, anticlockwise in S.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Coriolis makes rotation clockwise in N, anticlockwise in S.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Gyres rotate the same way in both hemispheres. -> Coriolis makes rotation clockwise in N, anticlockwise in S.

Q57. Answer: A | Environment

With reference to Ecosystem Structure and Function, consider the following statements: 1. Producers are the sole entry point of energy into an ecosystem; energy flow is unidirectional and matter/nutrient flow is cyclic. 2. A food web is a network of interconnected food chains, giving greater ecosystem stability than a single linear chain. 3. A food chain and a food web are interchangeable terms. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Ecosystem Structure and Function; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: A food web is the sum of interconnected food chains and gives more stability.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A food chain and a food web are interchangeable terms.' and replaces it with 'A food web is the sum of interconnected food chains and gives more stability.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A food chain and a food web are interchangeable terms.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: A food web is the sum of interconnected food chains and gives more stability.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: A food web is the sum of interconnected food chains and gives more stability.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A food chain and a food web are interchangeable terms. -> A food web is the sum of interconnected food chains and gives more stability.

Q58. Answer: B | Environment

With reference to Biogeochemical Cycles and Ecological Pyramids, consider the following statements: 1. Carbon, nitrogen, oxygen and water are gaseous (atmosphere/ocean-reservoir) cycles; phosphorus, sulphur and calcium are sedimentary (crust-reservoir) cycles. 2. Biological nitrogen fixation is chiefly carried out by bacteria (free-living, e.g. Azotobacter, and symbiotic, e.g. Rhizobium in legume root nodules). 3. A single ecosystem always shows the same pyramid shape for numbers, biomass and energy. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A single ecosystem always shows the same pyramid shape for numbers, biomass and energy.' and replaces it with 'Shape differs by parameter and ecosystem type (e.g., aquatic biomass pyramids commonly invert while the energy pyramid for the same system stays upright).'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Biogeochemical Cycles and Ecological Pyramids; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Shape differs by parameter and ecosystem type (e.g., aquatic biomass pyramids commonly invert while the energy pyramid for the same system stays upright).

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A single ecosystem always shows the same pyramid shape for numbers, biomass and energy.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Shape differs by parameter and ecosystem type (e.g., aquatic biomass pyramids commonly invert while the energy pyramid for the same system stays upright).

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Shape differs by parameter and ecosystem type (e.g., aquatic biomass pyramids commonly invert while the energy pyramid for the same system stays upright).

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A single ecosystem always shows the same pyramid shape for numbers, biomass and energy. -> Shape differs by parameter and ecosystem type (e.g., aquatic biomass pyramids commonly invert while the energy pyramid for the same system stays upright).

Q59. Answer: C | Environment

With reference to Ecological Succession and Biomes, consider the following statements: 1. Primary succession starts with no soil (bare rock/new land); secondary succession starts on existing soil after disturbance and is faster. 2. Lichens are

classic pioneer species in primary succession on rock; they aid rock weathering and initial soil formation. 3. Primary and secondary succession happen at the same speed. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Primary and secondary succession happen at the same speed.' and replaces it with 'Secondary succession is much faster because soil and often a seed bank already exist.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Primary and secondary succession happen at the same speed.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Ecological Succession and Biomes; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Secondary succession is much faster because soil and often a seed bank already exist.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Secondary succession is much faster because soil and often a seed bank already exist.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Secondary succession is much faster because soil and often a seed bank already exist.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Primary and secondary succession happen at the same speed. -> Secondary succession is much faster because soil and often a seed bank already exist.

Q60. Answer: D | Environment

With reference to Biodiversity Levels and Hotspots, consider the following statements: 1. Biodiversity has three levels: genetic, species and ecosystem diversity. 2. A hotspot must meet both Conservation International criteria - endemic vascular plant threshold and habitat-loss threshold - not just have "many species." 3. Hotspot status is a legally binding Indian conservation designation like a National Park. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Hotspot status is a legally binding Indian conservation designation like a National Park.' and replaces it with 'It is an international scientific-prioritisation framework, not a domestic legal protection category.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Hotspot status is a legally binding Indian conservation designation like a National Park.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It is an international scientific-prioritisation framework, not a domestic legal protection category.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Biodiversity Levels and Hotspots; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It is an international scientific-prioritisation framework, not a domestic legal protection category.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It is an international scientific-prioritisation framework, not a domestic legal protection category.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Hotspot status is a legally binding Indian conservation designation like a National Park. -> It is an international scientific-prioritisation framework, not a domestic legal protection category.

Q61. Answer: A | Environment

With reference to IUCN Red List and Endemism, consider the following statements: 1. The Red List category order (from least to most at risk) is: Least Concern, Near Threatened, Vulnerable, Endangered, Critically Endangered, Extinct in the Wild, Extinct. 2. "Threatened" collectively means Vulnerable + Endangered + Critically Endangered. 3. A species' Red List category and its Wildlife Protection Act Schedule are always identical. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about IUCN Red List and Endemism; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: The two classification systems are related but distinct and can diverge.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A species' Red List category and its Wildlife Protection Act Schedule are always identical.' and replaces it with 'The two classification systems are related but distinct and can diverge.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A species' Red List category and its Wildlife Protection Act Schedule are always identical.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: The two classification systems are related but distinct and can diverge.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: The two classification systems are related but distinct and can diverge.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A species' Red List category and its Wildlife Protection Act Schedule are always identical. -> The two classification systems are related but distinct and can diverge.

Q62. Answer: B | Environment

With reference to Protected Area Network India, consider the following statements: 1. The Wildlife Protection Act, 1972 provides four main protected-area categories: National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, Conservation Reserve and Community Reserve. 2. National Parks have the strictest regime; private rights/grazing are not normally permitted unless specifically allowed. 3. A Tiger Reserve is a distinct fifth legal category alongside NP/WLS/Conservation Reserve/Community Reserve. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A Tiger Reserve is a distinct fifth legal category alongside NP/WLS/Conservation Reserve/Community Reserve.' and replaces it with 'It is a management overlay (core/buffer under NTCA) typically declared over an existing National Park/Sanctuary, not a separate land-category under the core Wildlife Protection Act framework.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Protected Area Network India; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It is a management overlay (core/buffer under NTCA) typically declared over an existing National Park/Sanctuary, not a separate land-category under the core Wildlife Protection Act framework.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A Tiger Reserve is a distinct fifth legal category alongside NP/WLS/Conservation Reserve/Community Reserve.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It is a management overlay (core/buffer under NTCA) typically declared over an existing National Park/Sanctuary, not a separate land-category under the core Wildlife Protection Act framework.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It is a management overlay (core/buffer under NTCA) typically declared over an existing National Park/Sanctuary, not a separate land-category under the core Wildlife Protection Act framework.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A Tiger Reserve is a distinct fifth legal category alongside NP/WLS/Conservation Reserve/Community Reserve. -> It is a management overlay (core/buffer under NTCA) typically declared over an existing National Park/Sanctuary, not a separate land-category under the core Wildlife Protection Act framework.

Q63. Answer: C | Environment

With reference to Biosphere Reserves and Ramsar Sites, consider the following statements: 1. Biosphere Reserves are zoned into core, buffer and transition zones under the UNESCO MAB Programme model. 2. Not every Indian Biosphere Reserve is internationally UNESCO-recognised; recognition requires meeting MAB Programme criteria and formal inclusion in the World Network. 3. A Biosphere Reserve and a Ramsar Site are the same type of designation. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A Biosphere Reserve and a Ramsar Site are the same type of designation.' and replaces it with 'A Biosphere Reserve is a zoned, landscape-scale UNESCO MAB designation; a Ramsar Site is a wetland-specific international listing - they are distinct systems that may overlap.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A Biosphere Reserve and a Ramsar Site are the same type of designation.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Biosphere Reserves and Ramsar Sites; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: A Biosphere Reserve is a zoned, landscape-scale UNESCO MAB designation; a Ramsar Site is a wetland-specific international listing - they are distinct systems that may overlap.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: A Biosphere Reserve is a zoned, landscape-scale UNESCO MAB designation; a Ramsar Site is a wetland-specific international listing - they are distinct systems that may overlap.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: A Biosphere Reserve is a zoned, landscape-scale UNESCO MAB designation; a Ramsar Site is a wetland-specific international listing - they are distinct systems that may overlap.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A Biosphere Reserve and a Ramsar Site are the same type of designation. -> A Biosphere Reserve is a zoned, landscape-scale UNESCO MAB designation; a Ramsar Site is a wetland-specific international listing - they are distinct systems that may overlap.

Q64. Answer: D | Environment

With reference to Wildlife Protection Act and Schedules, consider the following statements: 1. The Wildlife Protection Act, 1972 is India's principal wildlife-protection statute. 2. Schedule I provides the highest/most stringent protection level under the Act. 3. Schedule IV listing gives a species higher protection than Schedule II. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Schedule IV listing gives a species higher protection than Schedule II.' and replaces it with 'Schedule IV is a trade-control schedule mirroring CITES Appendices, not a rung on the protection ladder.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Schedule IV listing gives a species higher protection than Schedule II.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Schedule IV is a trade-control schedule mirroring CITES Appendices, not a rung on the protection ladder.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Wildlife Protection Act and Schedules; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Schedule IV is a trade-control schedule mirroring CITES Appendices, not a rung on the protection ladder.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Schedule IV is a trade-control schedule mirroring CITES Appendices, not a rung on the protection ladder.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Schedule IV listing gives a species higher protection than Schedule II. -> Schedule IV is a trade-control schedule mirroring CITES Appendices, not a rung on the protection ladder.

Q65. Answer: A | Environment

With reference to CITES and Wildlife Trade, consider the following statements: 1. CITES has three Appendices: I (trade generally prohibited), II (trade regulated via permits) and III (country-specific protection needing a certificate of origin). 2. CITES regulates international trade specifically, not domestic hunting/habitat protection directly - those remain matters of each country's domestic law. 3. Appendix I allows regulated commercial trade with permits like Appendix II. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about CITES and Wildlife Trade; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Appendix I trade is generally prohibited for commercial purposes, with only narrow exceptions.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Appendix I allows regulated commercial trade with permits like Appendix II.' and replaces it with 'Appendix I trade is generally prohibited for commercial purposes, with only narrow exceptions.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Appendix I allows regulated commercial trade with permits like Appendix II.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Appendix I trade is generally prohibited for commercial purposes, with only narrow exceptions.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Appendix I trade is generally prohibited for commercial purposes, with only narrow exceptions.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Appendix I allows regulated commercial trade with permits like Appendix II. -> Appendix I trade is generally prohibited for commercial purposes, with only narrow exceptions.

Q66. Answer: B | Environment

With reference to CMS Bonn Convention Migratory Species, consider the following statements: 1. CMS (Bonn Convention, 1979) is administered under UNEP and focuses specifically on migratory species conservation across their entire range. 2. CMS has two main Appendices: Appendix I (strict protection) and Appendix II (cooperation encouraged through specific Agreements/MOUs). 3. CMS Appendix II listing carries the same strict, mandatory protection obligation as Appendix I. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'CMS Appendix II listing carries the same strict, mandatory protection obligation as Appendix I.' and replaces it with 'Appendix II primarily encourages range states to negotiate cooperative Agreements/MOUs, a more flexible mechanism than Appendix I's strict-protection duty.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about CMS Bonn Convention Migratory Species; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Appendix II primarily encourages range states to negotiate cooperative Agreements/MOUs, a more flexible mechanism than Appendix I's strict-protection duty.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: CMS Appendix II listing carries the same strict, mandatory protection obligation as Appendix I.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Appendix II primarily encourages range states to negotiate cooperative Agreements/MOUs, a more flexible mechanism than Appendix I's strict-protection duty.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Appendix II primarily encourages range states to negotiate cooperative Agreements/MOUs, a more flexible mechanism than Appendix I's strict-protection duty.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: CMS Appendix II listing carries the same strict, mandatory protection obligation as Appendix I. -> Appendix II primarily encourages range states to negotiate cooperative Agreements/MOUs, a more flexible mechanism than Appendix I's strict-protection duty.

Q67. Answer: C | Environment

With reference to Forest Types and Forest Rights Act, consider the following statements: 1. India's major forest types (by the Champion-Seth-style classification) include tropical wet evergreen, tropical moist/dry deciduous, tropical thorn, and montane/alpine types. 2. Tropical moist and dry deciduous forests together cover the largest share of India's forested area. 3. The FRA cut-off date is the date the Act came into force. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The FRA cut-off date is the date the Act came into force.' and replaces it with 'The statutory cut-off is 13 December 2005, prior to the Act's enactment.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The FRA cut-off date is the date the Act came into force.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Forest Types and Forest Rights Act; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: The statutory cut-off is 13 December 2005, prior to the Act's enactment.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: The statutory cut-off is 13 December 2005, prior to the Act's enactment.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: The statutory cut-off is 13 December 2005, prior to the Act's enactment.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The FRA cut-off date is the date the Act came into force. -> The statutory cut-off is 13 December 2005, prior to the Act's enactment.

Q68. Answer: D | Environment

With reference to Forest Governance CAMPA and Green India Mission, consider the following statements: 1. CAMPA is triggered specifically by diversion of forest land for non-forest use and is funded by user-agency payments (Net Present Value plus compensatory-afforestation cost). 2. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 established the National and State Compensatory Afforestation Funds and CAMPA's statutory governance structure. 3. The Green India Mission is one of India's international UNFCCC-mandated obligations specifically named in the Paris Agreement text. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The Green India Mission is one of India's international UNFCCC-mandated obligations specifically named in the Paris Agreement text.' and replaces it with 'It is a domestic NAPCC mission that contributes to, but was not created by, India's international climate commitments.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The Green India Mission is one of India's international UNFCCC-mandated obligations specifically named in the Paris Agreement text.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It is a domestic NAPCC mission that contributes to, but was not created by, India's international climate commitments.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Forest Governance CAMPA and Green India Mission; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It is a domestic NAPCC mission that contributes to, but was not created by, India's international climate commitments.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It is a domestic NAPCC mission that contributes to, but was not created by, India's international climate commitments.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Green India Mission is one of India's international UNFCCC-mandated obligations specifically named in the Paris Agreement text. -> It is a domestic NAPCC mission that contributes to, but was not created by, India's international climate commitments.

Q69. Answer: A | Science and Technology

With reference to Space Programme, ISRO, Launch Vehicles and Space Governance, consider the following statements:

1. SLV-3 was India's first experimental satellite launch vehicle; ASLV served as an intermediate technology-learning step before PSLV. 2. ISRO's Launchers page lists PSLV, GSLV and LVM3 as active operational launch vehicles. 3. ISRO, NSIL and IN-SPACe are just three names for the same organisation. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Space Programme, ISRO, Launch Vehicles and Space Governance; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: ISRO is the public agency; NSIL is the commercial PSU; IN-SPACe is the authorisation/promotional interface for private activity.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'ISRO, NSIL and IN-SPACe are just three names for the same organisation.' and replaces it with 'ISRO is the public agency; NSIL is the commercial PSU; IN-SPACe is the authorisation/promotional interface for private activity.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: ISRO, NSIL and IN-SPACe are just three names for the same organisation.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: ISRO is the public agency; NSIL is the commercial PSU; IN-SPACe is the authorisation/promotional interface for private activity.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: ISRO is the public agency; NSIL is the commercial PSU; IN-SPACe is the authorisation/promotional interface for private activity.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: ISRO, NSIL and IN-SPACe are just three names for the same organisation. -> ISRO is the public agency; NSIL is the commercial PSU; IN-SPACe is the authorisation/promotional interface for private activity.

Q70. Answer: B | Science and Technology

With reference to Satellites, NavIC, GAGAN and Applications, consider the following statements: 1. NavIC is India's independent regional satellite navigation system; it is not India's name for GPS. 2. ISRO states that NavIC provides two services: Standard Positioning Service (SPS) and Restricted Service (RS). 3. "NavIC has 11 satellites, so it is a large constellation.". Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects "'NavIC has 11 satellites, so it is a large constellation.'" and replaces it with 'Cumulative launches are not constellation strength. Count functional satellites on a stated date, and remember that some launched satellites have been decommissioned or failed to reach their intended orbit.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Satellites, NavIC, GAGAN and Applications; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Cumulative launches are not constellation strength. Count functional satellites on a stated date, and remember that some launched satellites have been decommissioned or failed to reach their intended orbit.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: "NavIC has 11 satellites, so it is a large constellation.".

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Cumulative launches are not constellation strength. Count functional satellites on a stated date, and remember that some launched satellites have been decommissioned or failed to reach their intended orbit.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Cumulative launches are not constellation strength. Count functional satellites on a stated date, and remember that some launched satellites have been decommissioned or failed to reach their intended orbit.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: "NavIC has 11 satellites, so it is a large constellation." -> Cumulative launches are not constellation strength. Count functional satellites on a stated date, and remember that some launched satellites have been decommissioned or failed to reach their intended orbit.

Q71. Answer: C | Science and Technology

With reference to Human Spaceflight, Gaganyaan and Planetary Missions, consider the following statements: 1. ISRO states that Gaganyaan envisages sending a crew of three members to about 400 km orbit for about three days and recovering them in Indian sea waters. 2. ISRO identifies Human Rated LVM3 (HLVM3) as the launcher for Gaganyaan. 3. Approved Bharatiya Antariksh Station or Venus Orbiter plans should be written as completed missions. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Approved Bharatiya Antariksh Station or Venus Orbiter plans should be written as completed missions.' and replaces it with 'They are approved/under-development roadmap items, not accomplished missions.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Approved Bharatiya Antariksh Station or Venus Orbiter plans should be written as completed missions.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Human Spaceflight, Gaganyaan and Planetary Missions; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: They are approved/under-development roadmap items, not accomplished missions.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: They are approved/under-development roadmap items, not accomplished missions.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: They are approved/under-development roadmap items, not accomplished missions.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Approved Bharatiya Antariksh Station or Venus Orbiter plans should be written as completed missions. -> They are approved/under-development roadmap items, not accomplished missions.

Q72. Answer: D | Science and Technology

With reference to Nuclear Power and the Three-Stage Programme, consider the following statements: 1. Homi Bhabha's three-stage strategy was built around India's limited uranium and large thorium endowment. 2. Stage 1 relies on PHWRs using natural uranium; the resulting spent fuel provides plutonium relevant for later stages. 3. PHWR and PWR are the same because both mention "pressurised water.". Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'PHWR and PWR are the same because both mention "pressurised water."' and replaces it with 'PHWR uses heavy water and is linked to natural-uranium strategy; PWR uses light water with a different design logic.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: PHWR and PWR are the same because both mention "pressurised water.".

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: PHWR uses heavy water and is linked to natural-uranium strategy; PWR uses light water with a different design logic.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Nuclear Power and the Three-Stage Programme; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: PHWR uses heavy water and is linked to natural-uranium strategy; PWR uses light water with a different design logic.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: PHWR uses heavy water and is linked to natural-uranium strategy; PWR uses light water with a different design logic.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: PHWR and PWR are the same because both mention "pressurised water.". -> PHWR uses heavy water and is linked to natural-uranium strategy; PWR uses light water with a different design logic.

Q73. Answer: A | Science and Technology

With reference to Nuclear Fusion and ITER, consider the following statements: 1. Fusion is different from fission: fusion combines light nuclei, while fission splits heavy nuclei. 2. A tokamak is a magnetic-confinement device; ITER follows the magnetic-confinement route, not inertial confinement. 3. ITER is a power plant that will soon feed electricity to the grid. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Nuclear Fusion and ITER; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: ITER is an experimental facility for demonstrating feasibility, not a commercial electricity plant; it has no turbine.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'ITER is a power plant that will soon feed electricity to the grid.' and replaces it with 'ITER is an experimental facility for demonstrating feasibility, not a commercial electricity plant; it has no turbine.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: ITER is a power plant that will soon feed electricity to the grid.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: ITER is an experimental facility for demonstrating feasibility, not a commercial electricity plant; it has no turbine.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: ITER is an experimental facility for demonstrating feasibility, not a commercial electricity plant; it has no turbine.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: ITER is a power plant that will soon feed electricity to the grid. -> ITER is an experimental facility for demonstrating feasibility, not a commercial electricity plant; it has no turbine.

Q74. Answer: B | Science and Technology

With reference to Defence R&D, DRDO and Missile Systems, consider the following statements: 1. DRDO's official site says the organisation was formed in 1958. 2. DRDO's official site says it now works through around 41 laboratories and 05 DRDO Young Scientist Laboratories. 3. A missile and a launch vehicle are the same thing. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A missile and a launch vehicle are the same thing.' and replaces it with 'Missile systems are weapons; launch vehicles are space-access systems. Propulsion overlap does not erase the functional distinction.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Defence R&D, DRDO and Missile Systems; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Missile systems are weapons; launch vehicles are space-access systems. Propulsion overlap does not erase the functional distinction.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A missile and a launch vehicle are the same thing.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Missile systems are weapons; launch vehicles are space-access systems. Propulsion overlap does not erase the functional distinction.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Missile systems are weapons; launch vehicles are space-access systems. Propulsion overlap does not erase the functional distinction.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A missile and a launch vehicle are the same thing. -> Missile systems are weapons; launch vehicles are space-access systems. Propulsion overlap does not erase the functional distinction.

Q75. Answer: C | Science and Technology

With reference to Defence Indigenization, Atmanirbhar and Procurement, consider the following statements: 1. The official DDP node shows DAP 2020 as a published government document dated 14 Dec 2020. 2. DAP 2020 broadly classifies capital-acquisition schemes as Buy, Buy and Make, Leasing, Make, Design and Development, and Strategic Partnership Model. 3. "Buy (Indian-IDDM), Buy (Indian) and Buy (Global)" is the complete DAP 'Buy' ladder. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects "'Buy (Indian-IDDM), Buy (Indian) and Buy (Global)" is the complete DAP 'Buy' ladder." and replaces it with 'Buy & Make (Indian) and Buy (Global - Manufacture in India) are also core categories, and they are exactly where technology transfer and local manufacture are negotiated.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: "Buy (Indian-IDDM), Buy (Indian) and Buy (Global)" is the complete DAP 'Buy' ladder.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Defence Indigenization, Atmanirbhar and Procurement; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Buy & Make (Indian) and Buy (Global - Manufacture in India) are also core categories, and they are exactly where technology transfer and local manufacture are negotiated.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Buy & Make (Indian) and Buy (Global - Manufacture in India) are also core categories, and they are exactly where technology transfer and local manufacture are negotiated.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Buy & Make (Indian) and Buy (Global - Manufacture in India) are also core categories, and they are exactly where technology transfer and local manufacture are negotiated.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: "Buy (Indian-IDDM), Buy (Indian) and Buy (Global)" is the complete DAP 'Buy' ladder. -> Buy & Make (Indian) and Buy (Global - Manufacture in India) are also core categories, and they are exactly where technology transfer and local manufacture are negotiated.

Q76. Answer: D | Science and Technology

With reference to Digital India and India Stack, UPI, Aadhaar, consider the following statements: 1. UIDAI's official page says UIDAI is a statutory authority established under the Aadhaar Act, 2016, under MeitY. 2. UIDAI's official page says Aadhaar is meant to issue unique IDs to residents and support authenticable identity. 3. Account Aggregator stores and owns customer financial data. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Account Aggregator stores and owns customer financial data.' and replaces it with 'RBI directions explicitly say the financial information is not the property of the AA and cannot be used in any other manner.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Account Aggregator stores and owns customer financial data.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: RBI directions explicitly say the financial information is not the property of the AA and cannot be used in any other manner.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Digital India and India Stack, UPI, Aadhaar; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: RBI directions explicitly say the financial information is not the property of the AA and cannot be used in any other manner.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: RBI directions explicitly say the financial information is not the property of the AA and cannot be used in any other manner.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Account Aggregator stores and owns customer financial data. -> RBI directions explicitly say the financial information is not the property of the AA and cannot be used in any other manner.

Q77. Answer: A | Science and Technology

With reference to Artificial Intelligence, Governance and IndiaAI, consider the following statements: 1. The seven pillars, in their current official labels, are IndiaAI Innovation Centre, IndiaAI Application Development Initiative, AIKosh Platform, IndiaAI Compute Capacity, IndiaAI Startup Financing, IndiaAI FutureSkills and Safe & Trusted AI. 2. NITI Aayog authored the National Strategy for AI (#AIforAll, 2018); MeitY/IndiaAI runs the mission. Strategy authorship and mission implementation sit in different institutions. 3. AI, machine learning and generative AI mean the same thing. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Artificial Intelligence, Governance and IndiaAI; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: They are nested categories; a rule-based expert system is AI but not ML, and an ML classifier is not generative AI.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'AI, machine learning and generative AI mean the same thing.' and replaces it with 'They are nested categories; a rule-based expert system is AI but not ML, and an ML classifier is not generative AI.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: AI, machine learning and generative AI mean the same thing.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: They are nested categories; a rule-based expert system is AI but not ML, and an ML classifier is not generative AI.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: They are nested categories; a rule-based expert system is AI but not ML, and an ML classifier is not generative AI.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: AI, machine learning and generative AI mean the same thing. -> They are nested categories; a rule-based expert system is AI but not ML, and an ML classifier is not generative AI.

Q78. Answer: B | Science and Technology

With reference to National Quantum Mission and Quantum Tech, consider the following statements: 1. DST's official NQM page says the mission has four Thematic Hubs. 2. The four hubs are for Quantum Computing, Quantum Communication, Quantum Sensing & Metrology, and Quantum Materials & Devices. 3. "Quantum supremacy" means quantum computers are now better than classical ones. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects "'Quantum supremacy' means quantum computers are now better than classical ones.' and replaces it with 'Supremacy claims involve contrived benchmark tasks and have been contested; practical quantum advantage on a useful problem has not been established.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about National Quantum Mission and Quantum Tech; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Supremacy claims involve contrived benchmark tasks and have been contested; practical quantum advantage on a useful problem has not been established.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: "Quantum supremacy" means quantum computers are now better than classical ones.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Supremacy claims involve contrived benchmark tasks and have been contested; practical quantum advantage on a useful problem has not been established.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Supremacy claims involve contrived benchmark tasks and have been contested; practical quantum advantage on a useful problem has not been established.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: "Quantum supremacy" means quantum computers are now better than classical ones. -> Supremacy claims involve contrived benchmark tasks and have been contested; practical quantum advantage on a useful problem has not been established.

Q79. Answer: C | Governance and Security

With reference to Multi-Hazard Early Warning and Disaster Technology, consider the following statements: 1. Nowcasting provides ultra-short-term forecasts (5-30 minutes ahead). 2. Doppler radar/hydro-meteorological networks give 3-6 hours' lead time for urban-flood rainfall monitoring. 3. Technology alone (GIS, satellites, apps) is sufficient for effective early warning. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Technology alone (GIS, satellites, apps) is sufficient for effective early warning.' and replaces it with 'VisionIAS's own urban-flood material shows warning effectiveness also depends on institutional authority (DSS output issued only via government officials) and local action capacity, not technology alone.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Technology alone (GIS, satellites, apps) is sufficient for effective early warning.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Multi-Hazard Early Warning and Disaster Technology; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: VisionIAS's own urban-flood material shows warning effectiveness also depends on institutional authority (DSS output issued only via government officials) and local action capacity, not technology alone.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: VisionIAS's own urban-flood material shows warning effectiveness also depends on institutional authority (DSS output issued only via government officials) and local action capacity, not technology alone.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: VisionIAS's own urban-flood material shows warning effectiveness also depends on institutional authority (DSS output issued only via government officials) and local action capacity, not technology alone.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Technology alone (GIS, satellites, apps) is sufficient for effective early warning. -> VisionIAS's own urban-flood material shows warning effectiveness also depends on institutional authority (DSS output issued only via government officials) and local action capacity, not technology alone.

Q80. Answer: D | Governance and Security

With reference to Earthquake Risk and Resilient Construction, consider the following statements: 1. Earthquake magnitude for large events is commonly reported on the moment magnitude scale (Mw); intensity (observed effects) may be expressed on the Modified Mercalli Intensity (MMI) or MSK scale. 2. India has four seismic zones (II-V) per IS 1893 (Part 1): 2016; Zone V is the highest-hazard zone, covering the whole of North-East India and Andaman & Nicobar, plus parts of northern Bihar, J&K/Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand and Gujarat. 3. Richter and Mercalli scales measure the same thing. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Richter and Mercalli scales measure the same thing.' and replaces it with 'Magnitude (energy released, commonly Mw for large events) and intensity (observed effects, expressed via MMI/MSK) are distinct dimensions - the Richter scale is an older, magnitude-limited local scale, not the universal current standard.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Richter and Mercalli scales measure the same thing.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Magnitude (energy released, commonly Mw for large events) and intensity (observed effects, expressed via MMI/MSK) are distinct dimensions - the Richter scale is an older, magnitude-limited local scale, not the universal current standard.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Earthquake Risk and Resilient Construction; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Magnitude (energy released, commonly Mw for large events) and intensity (observed effects, expressed via MMI/MSK) are distinct dimensions - the Richter scale is an older, magnitude-limited local scale, not the universal current standard.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Magnitude (energy released, commonly Mw for large events) and intensity (observed effects, expressed via MMI/MSK) are distinct dimensions - the Richter scale is an older, magnitude-limited local scale, not the universal current standard.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Richter and Mercalli scales measure the same thing. -> Magnitude (energy released, commonly Mw for large events) and intensity (observed effects, expressed via MMI/MSK) are distinct dimensions - the Richter scale is an older, magnitude-limited local scale, not the universal

current standard.

Q81. Answer: A | Governance and Security

With reference to Tsunami and Coastal Hazard Management, consider the following statements: 1. India's Tsunami Early Warning System detects tsunamigenic earthquakes in the Indian Ocean in under 10 minutes. 2. The system was established with Department of Space, DST and CSIR. 3. The 2,200 km shoreline and "13 tsunamis in 300 years" figures are current statistics requiring no further check. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Tsunami and Coastal Hazard Management; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Treat as document- period figures reported from historical record; cite a current INCOIS/ GSI source for any precision-dependent claim.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The 2,200 km shoreline and "13 tsunamis in 300 years" figures are current statistics requiring no further check.' and replaces it with 'Treat as document- period figures reported from historical record; cite a current INCOIS/ GSI source for any precision-dependent claim.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The 2,200 km shoreline and "13 tsunamis in 300 years" figures are current statistics requiring no further check.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Treat as document- period figures reported from historical record; cite a current INCOIS/ GSI source for any precision-dependent claim.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Treat as document- period figures reported from historical record; cite a current INCOIS/ GSI source for any precision-dependent claim.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The 2,200 km shoreline and "13 tsunamis in 300 years" figures are current statistics requiring no further check. -> Treat as document- period figures reported from historical record; cite a current INCOIS/ GSI source for any precision-dependent claim.

Q82. Answer: B | Governance and Security

With reference to Cyclones, Storm Surge and Coastal Preparedness, consider the following statements: 1. IMD uses four colour codes: Green (no warning), Yellow (be updated), Orange (be prepared), Red (take action). 2. ACWCs are at Kolkata, Chennai and Mumbai; CWCs at Bhubaneswar, Visakhapatnam and Ahmedabad. 3. The colour codes and the cyclone bulletin stages are the same system. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The colour codes and the cyclone bulletin stages are the same system.' and replaces it with 'Green/Yellow/Orange/Red communicate action level; Pre-Cyclone Watch/Alert/Warning/Post-Landfall Outlook communicate lead time (72/48/24/12 hours). Both may apply to the same system simultaneously.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Cyclones, Storm Surge and Coastal Preparedness; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Green/Yellow/Orange/Red communicate action level; Pre-Cyclone Watch/Alert/Warning/Post-Landfall Outlook communicate lead time (72/48/24/12 hours). Both may apply to the same system simultaneously.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The colour codes and the cyclone bulletin stages are the same system.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Green/Yellow/Orange/Red communicate action level; Pre-Cyclone Watch/Alert/Warning/Post-Landfall Outlook communicate lead time (72/48/24/12 hours). Both may apply to the same system simultaneously.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Green/Yellow/Orange/Red communicate action level; Pre-Cyclone Watch/Alert/Warning/Post-Landfall Outlook communicate lead time (72/48/24/12 hours). Both may apply to the same system simultaneously.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The colour codes and the cyclone bulletin stages are the same system. -> Green/Yellow/Orange/Red communicate action level; Pre-Cyclone Watch/Alert/Warning/Post-Landfall Outlook communicate lead time (72/48/24/12 hours). Both may apply to the same system simultaneously.

Q83. Answer: C | Governance and Security

With reference to Riverine Floods and Urban Flood Resilience, consider the following statements: 1. More than 40 million hectares of India's land area is flood-prone (Rashtriya Barh Ayog assessment). 2. CWC supplies discharge data; IMD supplies rainfall data, for flood forecasting. 3. The "40 million hectare" flood-prone-area figure and district/state lists are current without verification. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The "40 million hectare" flood-prone-area figure and district/state lists are current without verification.' and replaces it with 'These are document-period figures from the Rashtriya Barh Ayog assessment cited in VisionIAS; verify against current CWC/NDMA data before precision-dependent use.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The "40 million hectare" flood-prone-area figure and district/state lists are current without verification.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Riverine Floods and Urban Flood Resilience; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: These are document-period figures from the Rashtriya Barh Ayog assessment cited in VisionIAS; verify against current CWC/NDMA data before precision-dependent use.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: These are document-period figures from the Rashtriya Barh Ayog assessment cited in VisionIAS; verify against current CWC/NDMA data before precision-dependent use.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: These are document-period figures from the Rashtriya Barh Ayog assessment cited in VisionIAS; verify against current CWC/NDMA data before precision-dependent use.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The "40 million hectare" flood-prone-area figure and district/state lists are current without verification. -> These are document-period figures from the Rashtriya Barh Ayog assessment cited in VisionIAS; verify against current CWC/NDMA data before precision-dependent use.

Q84. Answer: D | Governance and Security

With reference to Drought, Heat Waves and Slow-Onset Risk, consider the following statements: 1. Four drought types: meteorological, agricultural, hydrological, ecological (Section 2). 2. IMD names five drought situations (Section 2). 3. The 68%-drought-prone and ~820-million-water-scarce figures, and the CWMI's specific state rankings, are current without verification. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The 68%-drought-prone and ~820-million-water-scarce figures, and the CWMI's specific state rankings, are current without verification.' and replaces it with 'These are document-period statistics; verify against current NITI Aayog/IMD/Jal Shakti sources before precision-dependent citation.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The 68%-drought-prone and ~820-million-water-scarce figures, and the CWMI's specific state rankings, are current without verification.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: These are document-period statistics; verify against current NITI Aayog/IMD/Jal Shakti sources before precision-dependent citation.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Drought, Heat Waves and Slow-Onset Risk; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: These are document-period statistics; verify against current NITI Aayog/IMD/Jal Shakti sources before precision-dependent citation.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: These are document-period statistics; verify against current NITI Aayog/IMD/Jal Shakti sources before precision-dependent citation.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The 68%-drought-prone and ~820-million-water-scarce figures, and the CWMI's specific state rankings, are current without verification. -> These are document-period statistics; verify against current NITI Aayog/IMD/Jal Shakti sources before precision-dependent citation.

Q85. Answer: A | Governance and Security

With reference to Landslides, Avalanches and GLOF Risk, consider the following statements: 1. A cloudburst is classified at roughly 10 cm or more rainfall per hour over ~20-30 sq km. 2. Landslides affect at least 15% of India's land area (document-period estimate). 3. The "15% of land area" and vulnerability-zone lists are current without verification. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Landslides, Avalanches and GLOF Risk; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Treat as document-period estimates; verify against current GSI/NDMA sources.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The "15% of land area" and vulnerability-zone lists are current without verification.' and replaces it with 'Treat as document-period estimates; verify against current GSI/NDMA sources.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The "15% of land area" and vulnerability-zone lists are current without verification.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Treat as document-period estimates; verify against current GSI/NDMA sources.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Treat as document-period estimates; verify against current GSI/NDMA sources.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The "15% of land area" and vulnerability-zone lists are current without verification. -> Treat as document-period estimates; verify against current GSI/NDMA sources.

Q86. Answer: B | Governance and Security

With reference to Forest Fire Risk Management, consider the following statements: 1. More than 95% of forest fires are human-caused (negligent or deliberate). 2. India's fire triangle: fuel + oxygen (naturally present) + heat (the initiating factor). 3. The "95% human-caused" and district-concentration percentages are necessarily current. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The "95% human-caused" and district-concentration percentages are necessarily current.' and replaces it with 'These are document-period statistics; verify against current FSI/MoEFCC reporting before precision-dependent citation.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Forest Fire Risk Management; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: These are document-period statistics; verify against current FSI/MoEFCC reporting before precision-dependent citation.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The "95% human-caused" and district-concentration percentages are necessarily current.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: These are document-period statistics; verify against current FSI/MoEFCC reporting before precision-dependent citation.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: These are document-period statistics; verify against current FSI/MoEFCC reporting before precision-dependent citation.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The "95% human-caused" and district-concentration percentages are necessarily current. -> These are document-period statistics; verify against current FSI/MoEFCC reporting before precision-dependent citation.

Q87. Answer: C | Governance and Security

With reference to Industrial, Chemical, Nuclear and CBRN Emergencies, consider the following statements: 1. The Chemical Accident Rules, 1996 established a Central Crisis Group chaired by the Environment Ministry Secretary. 2. The Public Liability Insurance Act, 1991 introduced "no fault liability" and established the Environmental Relief Fund (2008). 3. India's nuclear-power capacity/target figures cited by VisionIAS are current. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'India's nuclear-power capacity/target figures cited by VisionIAS are current.' and replaces it with 'Any nuclear-capacity claim (e.g. electricity-share targets) requires current DAE/AERB verification; do not assume document-period ambitions remain the current plan.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: India's nuclear-power capacity/target figures cited by VisionIAS are current.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Industrial, Chemical, Nuclear and CBRN Emergencies; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Any nuclear-capacity claim (e.g. electricity-share targets) requires current DAE/AERB verification; do not assume document-period ambitions remain the current plan.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Any nuclear-capacity claim (e.g. electricity-share targets) requires current DAE/AERB verification; do not assume document-period ambitions remain the current plan.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Any nuclear-capacity claim (e.g. electricity-share targets) requires current DAE/AERB verification; do not assume document-period ambitions remain the current plan.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: India's nuclear-power capacity/target figures cited by VisionIAS are current. -> Any nuclear-capacity claim (e.g. electricity-share targets) requires current DAE/AERB verification; do not assume document-period ambitions remain the current plan.

Q88. Answer: D | Governance and Security

With reference to Urban and Critical Infrastructure Resilience, consider the following statements: 1. CDRI was launched by India at the UN Climate Action Summit, New York, on 23 September 2019. 2. CDRI has four thematic areas: risk assessment, design/implementation standards, financing mechanisms, reconstruction/recovery. 3. Urban-flood management is solved by drainage redesign alone. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Urban-flood management is solved by drainage redesign alone.' and replaces it with 'CDRI and VisionIAS's own framework require risk assessment, design standards, financing and recovery planning together - drainage is one structural component among several (Section 4).'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Urban-flood management is solved by drainage redesign alone.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: CDRI and VisionIAS's own framework require risk assessment, design standards, financing and recovery planning together - drainage is one structural component among several (Section 4).

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Urban and Critical Infrastructure Resilience; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: CDRI and VisionIAS's own framework require risk assessment, design standards, financing and recovery planning together - drainage is one structural component among several (Section 4).

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: CDRI and VisionIAS's own framework require risk assessment, design standards, financing and recovery planning together - drainage is one structural component among several (Section 4).

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Urban-flood management is solved by drainage redesign alone. -> CDRI and VisionIAS's own framework require risk assessment, design standards, financing and recovery planning together - drainage is one structural component among several (Section 4).

Q89. Answer: A | Governance and Security

With reference to Climate Risk, Adaptation and Loss and Damage, consider the following statements: 1. Slow-onset disasters include climate change, desertification, soil degradation and drought. 2. The Warsaw International Mechanism on Loss and Damage was established at COP19 (2013). 3. Loss-and-damage finance figures can be cited without a specific COP decision/date. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Climate Risk, Adaptation and Loss and Damage; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Any numeric loss-and-damage finance claim must cite the specific COP decision and date; VisionIAS does not itself provide current finance figures.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Loss-and-damage finance figures can be cited without a specific COP decision/date.' and replaces it with 'Any numeric loss-and-damage finance claim must cite the specific COP decision and date; VisionIAS does not itself provide current finance figures.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Loss-and-damage finance figures can be cited without a specific COP decision/date.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Any numeric loss-and-damage finance claim must cite the specific COP decision and date; VisionIAS does not itself provide current finance figures.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Any numeric loss-and-damage finance claim must cite the specific COP decision and date; VisionIAS does not itself provide current finance figures.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Loss-and-damage finance figures can be cited without a specific COP decision/date. -> Any numeric loss-and-damage finance claim must cite the specific COP decision and date; VisionIAS does not itself provide current finance figures.

Q90. Answer: B | Governance and Security

With reference to Disaster Finance, Risk Transfer and Build Back Better, consider the following statements: 1. Four risk-management strategies: acceptance, avoidance, reduction, transfer (insurance being the most common transfer form). 2. SDRF funds immediate State-level relief; the National Disaster Response Fund provides Centre-level assistance beyond SDRF capacity. 3. The Rs 5,690 crore/Rs 2,500 crore NCCD figures are current. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The Rs 5,690 crore/Rs 2,500 crore NCCD figures are current.' and replaces it with 'Document- period (2015-16/2018-19) figures; cite a current source for any present-day NCCD-revenue claim.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Disaster Finance, Risk Transfer and Build Back Better; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Document- period (2015-16/2018-19) figures; cite a current source for any present-day NCCD-revenue claim.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The Rs 5,690 crore/Rs 2,500 crore NCCD figures are current.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Document-period (2015-16/2018-19) figures; cite a current source for any present-day NCCD-revenue claim.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Document- period (2015-16/2018-19) figures; cite a current source for any present-day NCCD-revenue claim.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Rs 5,690 crore/Rs 2,500 crore NCCD figures are current. -> Document- period (2015-16/2018-19) figures; cite a current source for any present-day NCCD-revenue claim.

Q91. Answer: C | Current Affairs

With reference to Union Budget 2026-27 dated 1 February 2026, consider the following statements: 1. The Union Budget 2026-27 followed the Economic Survey on 1 February 2026. 2. The Annual Financial Statement is constitutionally linked to Article 112. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 converts a policy, institutional or scientific development into an automatic constitutional entitlement.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also supported by the dated official source, while statement 3 remains false.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 preserve both the dated fact and the static legal or conceptual boundary; statement 3 overstates the event's legal effect.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the universal legal consequence in statement 3 does not follow from the event.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The Union Budget 2026-27 followed the Economic Survey on 1 February 2026. [Analysis] The Annual Financial Statement is constitutionally linked to Article 112.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q92. Answer: D | Current Affairs

With reference to Economic Survey 2025-26 dated 29 January 2026, consider the following statements: 1. The Economic Survey 2025-26 was tabled in Parliament on 29 January 2026. 2. The Survey is a policy and analytical document, not a constitutional money bill. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 converts a policy, institutional or scientific development into an automatic constitutional entitlement.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also supported by the dated official source, while statement 3 remains false.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the universal legal consequence in statement 3 does not follow from the event.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 preserve both the dated fact and the static legal or conceptual boundary; statement 3 overstates the event's legal effect.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The Economic Survey 2025-26 was tabled in Parliament on 29 January 2026. [Analysis] The Survey is a policy and analytical document, not a constitutional money bill.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q93. Answer: A | Current Affairs

With reference to Economic Survey growth assessment dated 29 January 2026, consider the following statements: 1. The Economic Survey placed FY 2025-26 real GDP growth at 7.4% FAE and projected FY 2026-27 growth at 6.8-7.2%. 2. A Survey projection is a dated analytical estimate, not a guaranteed outcome. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 preserve both the dated fact and the static legal or conceptual boundary; statement 3 overstates the event's legal effect.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 converts a policy, institutional or scientific development into an automatic constitutional entitlement.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also supported by the dated official source, while statement 3 remains false.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the universal legal consequence in statement 3 does not follow from the event.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The Economic Survey placed FY 2025-26 real GDP growth at 7.4% FAE and projected FY 2026-27 growth at 6.8-7.2%. [Analysis] A Survey projection is a dated analytical estimate, not a guaranteed outcome.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q94. Answer: B | Current Affairs

With reference to RBI macro-risk assessment dated 5 August 2026, consider the following statements: 1. RBI's 5 August 2026 statement flagged volatile oil, sticky global inflation, elevated yields, US-dollar strength and uneven monsoon risk. 2. External shocks affect inflation, growth, fiscal costs and the balance of payments through different transmission channels. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 converts a policy, institutional or scientific development into an automatic constitutional entitlement.

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 preserve both the dated fact and the static legal or conceptual boundary; statement 3 overstates the event's legal effect.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also supported by the dated official source, while statement 3 remains false.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the universal legal consequence in statement 3 does not follow from the event.

Method / explanation: [Fact] RBI's 5 August 2026 statement flagged volatile oil, sticky global inflation, elevated yields, US-dollar strength and uneven monsoon risk. [Analysis] External shocks affect inflation, growth, fiscal costs and the balance of payments through different transmission channels.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q95. Answer: C | Current Affairs

With reference to India's 100th Ramsar site milestone dated 5 June 2026, consider the following statements: 1. India reached 100 Ramsar sites on 5 June 2026, with Surha Tal in Ballia district recorded as the 100th site. 2. Ramsar designation recognises a Wetland of International Importance but does not by itself prove management effectiveness. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 converts a policy, institutional or scientific development into an automatic constitutional entitlement.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also supported by the dated official source, while statement 3 remains false.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 preserve both the dated fact and the static legal or conceptual boundary; statement 3 overstates the event's legal effect.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the universal legal consequence in statement 3 does not follow from the event.

Method / explanation: [Fact] India reached 100 Ramsar sites on 5 June 2026, with Surha Tal in Ballia district recorded as the 100th site. [Analysis] Ramsar designation recognises a Wetland of International Importance but does not by itself prove management effectiveness.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q96. Answer: D | Current Affairs

With reference to Non-fossil installed-capacity milestone dated 31 December 2025, consider the following statements: 1. Non-fossil sources accounted for 51.93% of India's installed power capacity at end-December 2025. 2. Installed capacity share is not the same as electricity-generation share or energy-consumption share. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 converts a policy, institutional or scientific development into an automatic constitutional entitlement.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also supported by the dated official source, while statement 3 remains false.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the universal legal consequence in statement 3 does not follow from the event.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 preserve both the dated fact and the static legal or conceptual boundary; statement 3 overstates the event's legal effect.

Method / explanation: [Fact] Non-fossil sources accounted for 51.93% of India's installed power capacity at end-December 2025. [Analysis] Installed capacity share is not the same as electricity-generation share or energy-consumption share.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q97. Answer: A | Current Affairs

With reference to Renewable-capacity addition dated 31 December 2025, consider the following statements: 1. India added 38.61 GW of renewable capacity in 2025-26 up to 31 December 2025, according to the Economic Survey evidence card. 2. Capacity added is a flow over a period; installed capacity is a stock at a date. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 preserve both the dated fact and the static legal or conceptual boundary; statement 3 overstates the event's legal effect.
- B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 converts a policy, institutional or scientific development into an automatic constitutional entitlement.
- C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also supported by the dated official source, while statement 3 remains false.
- D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the universal legal consequence in statement 3 does not follow from the event.

Method / explanation: [Fact] India added 38.61 GW of renewable capacity in 2025-26 up to 31 December 2025, according to the Economic Survey evidence card. [Analysis] Capacity added is a flow over a period; installed capacity is a stock at a date.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q98. Answer: B | Current Affairs

With reference to Kulasekarapattinam SSLV launch complex dated 21 June 2026, consider the following statements: 1. PIB material recorded the Kulasekarapattinam SSLV launch complex as under construction on 21 June 2026. 2. An approved or under-construction launch facility is not an operational facility. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 converts a policy, institutional or scientific development into an automatic constitutional entitlement.
- B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 preserve both the dated fact and the static legal or conceptual boundary; statement 3 overstates the event's legal effect.
- C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also supported by the dated official source, while statement 3 remains false.
- D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the universal legal consequence in statement 3 does not follow from the event.

Method / explanation: [Fact] PIB material recorded the Kulasekarapattinam SSLV launch complex as under construction on 21 June 2026. [Analysis] An approved or under-construction launch facility is not an operational facility.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q99. Answer: C | Current Affairs

With reference to India's BRICS 2026 chairship launch dated 13 January 2026, consider the following statements: 1. India launched the BRICS 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026; this did not establish that a Leaders' Summit had already been completed. 2. Chairship-process activity and a concluded summit outcome are distinct statuses. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 converts a policy, institutional or scientific development into an automatic constitutional entitlement.
- B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also supported by the dated official source, while statement 3 remains false.
- C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 preserve both the dated fact and the static legal or conceptual boundary; statement 3 overstates the event's legal effect.
- D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the universal legal consequence in statement 3 does not follow from the event.

Method / explanation: [Fact] India launched the BRICS 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026; this did not establish that a Leaders' Summit had already been completed. [Analysis] Chairship-process activity and a concluded summit outcome are distinct statuses.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q100. Answer: D | Current Affairs

With reference to BIMSTEC maritime transport agreement dated 16 May 2026, consider the following statements: 1. The BIMSTEC maritime transport agreement entered into force on 16 May 2026 among Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, the four states then recorded as having deposited instruments. 2. Entry into force among depositing states should not be described as binding every member automatically. 3. The dated development by itself created a constitutionally entrenched entitlement applicable in every case. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 3 converts a policy, institutional or scientific development into an automatic constitutional entitlement.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also supported by the dated official source, while statement 3 remains false.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the universal legal consequence in statement 3 does not follow from the event.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 preserve both the dated fact and the static legal or conceptual boundary; statement 3 overstates the event's legal effect.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The BIMSTEC maritime transport agreement entered into force on 16 May 2026 among Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, the four states then recorded as having deposited instruments. [Analysis] Entry into force among depositing states should not be described as binding every member automatically.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS